

## ENGLISH FOR BANKING OPERATIONS TEAMS

# Banking Operations English

Trace the transaction. Explain the status. Protect the record.

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**Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.**

**INSIDE THE BOOK**

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases  
160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps  
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For account services, payments, lending operations, financial-crime, controls, and complaint teams.

2026 edition

# Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight banking exchanges: complete account-opening checks, describe a monitoring alert, reconcile loan-document versions, report payment exceptions, clarify a disputed transaction, investigate a ledger difference, supply control evidence, and explain a fee review.

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Explain the missing ownership information without promising approval | Clarify an account-opening requirement, distinguish ownership from signing authority, and give a useful next step.

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A sign-off cannot erase an unmatched balance | Explain a reconciliation break, correct a misleading control status, and preserve evidence for the next reviewer.

## 07 Audit and Regulatory Exams

58

A policy describes the control but does not prove it operated | Respond to an evidence request with exact scope, honest availability, and traceable period coverage.

## 08 Customer Complaints and Fair Treatment

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The current fee schedule may not explain a past charge | Investigate a historical fee question using the applicable period, product, transaction, and waiver conditions.

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# Make each status word earn its place

Banking records distinguish requests, reviews, authorizations, postings, and settlements. These conversations practice explaining those stages while protecting confidential information and preserving the actual evidence behind a customer or control decision.

## Name the unresolved item

A pending application or exception needs a specific reason and next step. Identify the missing document or verification without guessing the facts or promising approval.

"The ownership information requested for this application remains incomplete."

## Do not turn an alert into an accusation

A monitoring alert starts a review; it does not prove wrongdoing. Describe observed activity and its source, preserve uncertainty, and use authorized confidential channels.

"The activity differs from the recorded profile; its explanation has not been established."

## Separate review from resolution

Examined, corrected, authorized, released, and settled describe different stages. A reviewed queue item may still require action, and a signed control record may still contain an unresolved exception.

"Thirty items were reviewed; that does not mean thirty were resolved."

## Answer the actual customer question

Explain the relevant transaction, date, amount, and next contact. Distinguish an interim credit or status update from a final outcome without withholding applicable rights or inventing deadlines.

"I will check the terms applicable on the transaction date, not assume today's schedule settles the charge."

### PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All banks, customers, accounts, transactions, figures, and local procedures are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not banking, legal, financial, compliance, or investigation advice. Actual obligations depend on the product, jurisdiction, facts, and current requirements. No exercise authorizes an account opening, fund transfer, record alteration, or disclosure of confidential reporting information.

# Explain the missing ownership information without promising approval

## A Read the situation

**Clarify an account-opening requirement, distinguish ownership from signing authority, and give a useful next step.**

Application A62 is the first business-account application by Northbank Design at this fictional bank. Its authorized-signatory details are supplied, but the ownership information requested for the applicable customer review is incomplete. Applicant representative Ken asks officer Zoya to open the account immediately and finish the review later. Under the stated local process, this application cannot be approved until the required review is complete. Zoya will provide the specific outstanding-information list through the verified secure channel and arrange a review-status update Thursday at 11:00. Neither complete documents nor that update guarantee approval.

PEOPLE / Ken: Applicant representative | Zoya: Account-opening officer

### EXPLAIN THE REQUIREMENT WITHOUT MAKING A UNIVERSAL LEGAL CLAIM

A customer may see repeated information requests as unnecessary. Describe the actual gap in this application and the authorized review route. Do not claim every entity or every additional account has identical requirements, and do not confuse signing authority with ownership.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is missing from A62?

- A Requested ownership information
- C The applicant's business name

- B All authorized-signatory details
- D A previously approved payment

2. What does the local process require before approval here?

- A Automatic acceptance after a status call
- C Only the applicant's urgent request

- B Completion of the required review
- D A promise to provide records later

3. What does Thursday at 11:00 represent?

- A Confirmation that ownership is verified
- C Guaranteed account approval

- B A review-status update
- D A funds-transfer deadline

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### Know Your Customer (KYC)

Processes used to understand and verify relevant customer information.

**IN USE complete KYC checks**

### customer due diligence (CDD)

Assessment of customer identity, relationship purpose, and relevant risk under applicable requirements.

**IN USE conduct customer due diligence**

### ownership structure

The arrangement of ownership interests in an entity.

**IN USE document the ownership structure**

### legal entity

An organization recognized as a distinct person under applicable law.

**IN USE identify the legal entity**

### beneficial owner

An individual meeting the applicable ownership or control definition for the review.

**IN USE identify the beneficial owner**

### authorized signatory

A person permitted to act or sign for an account under its mandate.

**IN USE verify the authorized signatory**

### Customer Identification Program (CIP)

A U.S. bank program for obtaining and verifying required customer identity information.

**IN USE follow the Customer Identification Program**

### control person

An individual meeting the applicable responsibility or control criterion.

**IN USE identify the control person**

### account mandate

Instructions defining who may operate an account and under what authority.

**IN USE review the account mandate**

### identity verification

Checking identity using the applicable evidence and process.

**IN USE complete identity verification**

### documentary verification

Verification using specified documents.

**IN USE perform documentary verification**

### non-documentary verification

Verification using appropriate methods other than specified identity documents.

**IN USE assess non-documentary verification**

### Precision check

An authorized signatory can operate an account under its mandate without necessarily being its beneficial owner. Supplying signatory details does not automatically answer the ownership question requested in this application.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### nature and purpose

The intended role and use of the customer relationship.

**IN USE** establish the nature and purpose

### expected activity

The anticipated account use relevant to understanding the relationship.

**IN USE** describe expected activity

### customer risk profile

The assessed characteristics relevant to the customer's risk context.

**IN USE** maintain the customer risk profile

### source of funds

The origin of money involved in a relationship or transaction.

**IN USE** clarify the source of funds

### source of wealth

The origin of a person's or entity's overall accumulated wealth.

**IN USE** distinguish source of wealth

### onboarding

The process of establishing a new customer relationship.

**IN USE** coordinate customer onboarding

### account application

A request to establish an account with supplied supporting information.

**IN USE** review the account application

### outstanding requirement

A requested or applicable condition that has not yet been satisfied.

**IN USE** identify an outstanding requirement

### verification status

The current stage of checking relevant information.

**IN USE** report verification status

### risk-based procedure

A process calibrated to relevant assessed risks and applicable requirements.

**IN USE** apply a risk-based procedure

### exception review

Authorized assessment of a proposed departure from a stated process.

**IN USE** request an exception review

### approval authority

The defined power to approve a specified action or relationship.

**IN USE** confirm approval authority

### Precision check

Requirements depend on the entity, relationship, applicable rules, and risk-based procedures. Current U.S. relief can affect repeated beneficial-owner identification at additional account openings. This first-account case does not teach a universal repeat-collection rule.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### IDENTIFY THE APPLICATION

"We are reviewing business-account application A62."

### NAME THE GAP

"The requested ownership information remains incomplete."

### STATE THE LOCAL CONDITION

"This application requires the review to be complete before approval."

### AVOID AN OVERRIDE PROMISE

"I cannot bypass the required review."

### NAME THE SUPPLIED INFORMATION

"We have the authorized-signatory details."

### SEPARATE ROLES

"Signing authority and beneficial ownership are different questions."

### RECOGNIZE URGENCY

"I understand that you want to begin using the account promptly."

### MAKE THE REQUEST SPECIFIC

"I will provide the outstanding-information list."

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### For this application

Restricts a statement to the supplied customer and process.

### Authorized to sign

Does not necessarily mean an owner of the entity.

### Remains incomplete

Describes information status without accusing the customer.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### **PROTECT THE SUBMISSION**

"Use the verified secure channel for the requested records."

### **EXPLAIN THE CONTEXT**

"Requirements must be assessed for this customer and application."

### **CHECK AUTHORITY**

"Any exception requires the applicable authorized review."

### **LIMIT THE COMMITMENT**

"That is an update appointment, not an approval guarantee."

### **AVOID UNNECESSARY REPETITION**

"We will identify what remains missing rather than request everything again."

### **KEEP STAGES DISTINCT**

"Complete documents do not automatically mean approved onboarding."

### **GIVE THE NEXT CONTACT**

"We will update the review status Thursday at 11:00."

### **CLOSE CONSTRUCTIVELY**

"Send the specified information so the relevant review can continue."

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### **Before approval**

Names a prerequisite, not a guarantee that satisfying it ensures acceptance.

### **Risk-based**

Requires relevant assessment, not arbitrary treatment or a universal checklist.

### **Verified channel**

Protects information without inventing an email address or collection route.



# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** Every entity has identical ownership requirements.
- B** We have signatory details, but the requested ownership information is incomplete.
- C** A signatory is always the only beneficial owner.
- D** Urgency proves that review is unnecessary.

### 2. What can Zoya promise?

- A** An exception without authorized assessment
- B** A specific missing-information list and a Thursday status update
- C** Guaranteed approval after any document upload
- D** Immediate use before required review

### 3. Which statement improperly generalizes the case?

- A** This is the customer's first account application here.
- B** The local process requires the stated review.
- C** Requirements depend on applicable rules and risk-based procedures.
- D** Every additional account always requires identical new ownership collection.

### 4. What does a completed information package establish by itself?

- A** Every identity is already verified.
- B** Every risk is eliminated.
- C** Account use is authorized without a decision.
- D** Information is supplied for review, not automatic approval.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

# Explain the missing ownership information without promising approval

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

ownership structure / authorized signatory / customer due diligence / account application / approval authority / risk-based procedure / nature and purpose / exception review / verification status / outstanding requirement

- 01 **Ken:** We supplied the people authorized to sign. Why is A62 still pending? We need to start using the business account this week.
- 02 **Zoya:** The requested <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ information is incomplete. We have the signatory details, but those answer a different question. I will identify the precise outstanding items rather than ask you to resend the entire application.
- 03 **Ken:** Our director can sign for the company. Does identifying her also settle the ownership question?
- 04 **Zoya:** An <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is not necessarily a beneficial owner. We need the information relevant to each role under this application's review. One person's signing authority does not establish the full ownership position.
- 05 **Ken:** Could you open the account now? We can promise to send the remaining information later.
- 06 **Zoya:** Under this local process, the required <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ review must be complete before this application can be approved. I cannot replace that step with a promise that the information will arrive later.
- 07 **Ken:** I understand the restriction. Please tell me exactly what is missing so I can ask our records team for the right material.
- 08 **Zoya:** I will send the <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ list through the verified secure channel. It will distinguish what we hold from what remains needed. That should help your team provide the relevant records without unnecessary duplication.
- 09 **Ken:** Are these requirements identical for every company and every account? A colleague said the rules had changed for some account openings.
- 10 **Zoya:** They depend on the applicable rules and <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Current requirements and relief must be assessed in context. This is your first business-account application here; I should not generalize its requirements to every additional account or entity.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Ken:** Does uploading the records complete the checks, or must someone still evaluate them?
- 12 **Zoya:** The <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ remains separate from document receipt. Supplying information allows the review to continue. It does not establish that every item has been verified or that the application has been approved.
- 13 **Ken:** Uploading does not mean the account is ready. Who can review a possible exception?
- 14 **Zoya:** Any <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ must follow the applicable authorized process. I cannot approve a bypass in this conversation. If a relevant question needs escalation, I will route it rather than invent an exception.
- 15 **Ken:** The form also asks how we expect to use the account. That is separate from identifying who owns or signs for the company.
- 16 **Zoya:** Yes. The <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ of the relationship helps establish the relevant customer context. Provide the requested factual description; do not choose an answer merely because you think it will make the review faster.
- 17 **Ken:** When will I hear from you? An accurate pending status would still help our planning.
- 18 **Zoya:** We will update the <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ status Thursday at eleven hundred. That is a communication appointment, not an approval guarantee. We will identify any continuing information gap or review step rather than imply a decision we do not have.
- 19 **Ken:** I will use the verified channel, supply the specified ownership records, and keep the distinction between submission and approval clear internally.
- 20 **Zoya:** Thank you. The eventual decision remains with the relevant <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. We can make the process understandable and keep the next contact reliable while preserving the required review and the actual account status.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. ownership structure | 2. authorized signatory | 3. customer due diligence | 4. outstanding requirement | 5. risk-based procedure | 6. verification status | 7. exception review | 8. nature and purpose | 9. account application | 10. approval authority

# Clarify another account application

## F Say it

Application B14 has signatory details but lacks the requested ownership chart. Hana will coordinate the review. The next status update is Monday at 10:00; approval is not guaranteed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

Monday at 10:00 / Hana / ownership chart / B14

Officer: "The application reference is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Applicant: "The missing document is the <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Officer: "The review coordinator is <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Applicant: "The next status update is <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. B14 | 2. ownership chart | 3. Hana | 4. Monday at 10:00

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# An unusual-activity alert is a question, not a verdict

## A Read the situation

**Write a neutral internal handoff and preserve confidential reporting boundaries.**

Monitoring analyst Sam receives alert T82 because recent transfers differ from the activity recorded in a business customer profile. The transaction records are available, but the business purpose and explanation for the change have not been established. A draft note says the customer is laundering money. Reviewer Aisha asks Sam to replace that conclusion with the observed difference and open questions, then follow the authorized Anti-Money Laundering (AML) review route. No reporting decision is supplied in this case. Suspicious Activity Report (SAR) information and its existence or nonexistence must not be disclosed through unauthorized channels.

PEOPLE / Sam: Monitoring analyst | Aisha: AML reviewer

### SEPARATE A SYSTEM SIGNAL FROM A HUMAN CONCLUSION

An alert can feel authoritative because a system produced it. Explain the actual observation and the missing context without treating the signal as proof. Keep the handoff factual and avoid using customer nationality, accent, or unfamiliarity as a substitute for relevant evidence.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

### 1. What does T82 identify?

**A** A confirmed harmless explanation

**B** Activity differing from the recorded customer profile

**C** A proven money-laundering offense

**D** A completed reporting decision

### 2. What is wrong with the draft note?

**A** It preserves uncertainty.

**B** It limits access to authorized reviewers.

**C** It states wrongdoing as established without the supporting finding.

**D** It identifies an alert reference.

### 3. What reporting decision is supplied?

**A** None

**B** A confirmed SAR filing

**C** A confirmed decision never to file

**D** Public disclosure to the customer

Answers and explanations: page 78.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## **B** Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### **Anti-Money Laundering (AML)**

Measures addressing the misuse of financial services to conceal or facilitate illicit funds.

**IN USE** conduct an AML review

### **Bank Secrecy Act (BSA)**

A U.S. framework of financial recordkeeping and reporting requirements.

**IN USE** assess applicable BSA requirements

### **transaction monitoring**

Review of financial activity for patterns requiring attention under the applicable process.

**IN USE** perform transaction monitoring

### **monitoring alert**

A signal identifying activity for further review.

**IN USE** investigate a monitoring alert

### **customer profile**

Recorded information about a customer and the relevant relationship context.

**IN USE** compare the customer profile

### **observed activity**

Transactions or conduct actually recorded or identified.

**IN USE** describe observed activity

### **business purpose**

The commercial reason given or established for activity.

**IN USE** clarify the business purpose

### **unusual activity**

Activity differing from an expected or relevant pattern and requiring context.

**IN USE** assess unusual activity

### **suspicious activity**

Activity meeting the relevant concern or reporting assessment under applicable requirements.

**IN USE** evaluate suspicious activity

### **Suspicious Activity Report (SAR)**

A confidential report made under applicable suspicious-activity reporting requirements.

**IN USE** protect SAR confidentiality

### **alert disposition**

The recorded outcome of an alert review.

**IN USE** document the alert disposition

### **case escalation**

Referral of a matter to the appropriate review level.

**IN USE** coordinate case escalation

### **Precision check**

An alert is not proof of criminal conduct and does not itself establish a reporting decision. A review can preserve concern without asserting wrongdoing or assuming that the activity has an innocent explanation.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### supporting records

Documents or data relevant to assessing the observed activity.

**IN USE preserve supporting records**

### transaction narrative

A clear description of relevant transaction facts and context.

**IN USE prepare a transaction narrative**

### source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

**IN USE retain source attribution**

### risk indicator

Information potentially relevant to assessing a concern.

**IN USE evaluate a risk indicator**

### contextual information

Background needed to interpret the observed facts.

**IN USE obtain contextual information**

### corroborating evidence

Additional information supporting or challenging an interpretation.

**IN USE review corroborating evidence**

### review rationale

The documented reasoning for an assessment or next step.

**IN USE explain the review rationale**

### reporting decision

A determination under the applicable process about required reporting.

**IN USE distinguish the reporting decision**

### confidentiality restriction

A limit on access or disclosure of protected information.

**IN USE observe confidentiality restrictions**

### authorized channel

An approved route for transmitting relevant information.

**IN USE use an authorized channel**

### need-to-know basis

Access limited to those requiring information for an authorized role.

**IN USE share on a need-to-know basis**

### neutral description

Factual wording without an unsupported adverse or favorable conclusion.

**IN USE use a neutral description**

### Precision check

SAR confidentiality includes information revealing whether a SAR exists. Do not disclose filing or nonfiling status to customers or unauthorized recipients. Use the applicable authorized channels and current requirements; this exercise teaches no filing threshold.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### IDENTIFY THE ITEM

"We are reviewing monitoring alert T82."

### NAME THE MISSING CONTEXT

"The business purpose has not been established."

### PRESERVE THE CONCERN

"The difference still requires review."

### LINK THE EVIDENCE

"Attach the relevant transaction references through the authorized channel."

### DESCRIBE THE OBSERVATION

"The transfers differ from the activity recorded in the customer profile."

### REMOVE THE UNSUPPORTED FINDING

"Do not describe money laundering as proven."

### AVOID PREMATURE REASSURANCE

"We have not established a harmless explanation either."

### ATTRIBUTE THE SOURCE

"Separate system records from unverified explanations."

---

### Differs from

Reports a comparison without supplying its cause.

### Has not been established

Preserves an unanswered question.

### Proven

Requires evidence beyond the existence of an alert.



# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### **KEEP THE NOTE NEUTRAL**

"Describe the observed activity and open questions."

### **SEPARATE REPORTING**

"An alert review is not itself a reporting decision."

### **RESTRICT DISTRIBUTION**

"Share the handoff only on a need-to-know basis."

### **RECORD THE RATIONALE**

"Explain why the matter needs further context."

### **USE THE REVIEW ROUTE**

"Escalate through the applicable AML process."

### **PROTECT CONFIDENTIALITY**

"Do not disclose SAR information through unauthorized channels."

### **AVOID AN IRRELEVANT PROXY**

"An accent or nationality is not evidence of wrongdoing."

### **CLOSE THE HANDOFF**

"Keep facts, uncertainty, review action, and reporting status distinct."

---

### **Neither conclusion**

Avoids both unsupported accusation and unsupported clearance.

### **Whether a report exists**

Information that can itself be confidential.

### **Relevant evidence**

Refers to the activity and context, not a demographic shortcut.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which internal note fits the case?

- A** T82 identifies transfers differing from the profile; business purpose unestablished; referred for authorized review.
- B** The customer is proven to be laundering money.
- C** The alert is harmless because the customer sounded polite.
- D** A SAR has been filed because an alert exists.

### 2. What should the reviewer not use as proof?

- A** Verified account context
- B** Documented business-purpose evidence
- C** The customer's accent or nationality
- D** Relevant transaction records

### 3. Which disclosure is inappropriate through an unauthorized channel?

- A** The assigned internal alert reference to its authorized reviewer
- B** Relevant records sent through the approved review route
- C** A neutral handoff within the permitted team
- D** Whether a SAR exists for the customer

### 4. What should the record preserve?

- A** Only the strongest accusation
- B** A guessed business purpose
- C** A fabricated reporting decision
- D** Sources, observed facts, uncertainty, and the review rationale

Answers and explanations: page 78.

# An unusual-activity alert is a question, not a verdict

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

authorized channel / review rationale / neutral description / unusual activity / business purpose / source attribution / alert disposition / case escalation / reporting decision / confidentiality restriction

- 01 **Sam:** Alert T82 shows transfers that differ from the recorded customer profile. My draft says the customer is laundering money, but the explanation is still unknown.
- 02 **Aisha:** Use a <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. The alert identifies a difference requiring review. It does not establish wrongdoing, and our note should not supply a conclusion that the available evidence has not established.
- 03 **Sam:** I can identify the relevant transactions and the profile used for comparison. I cannot yet explain the business reason for the change.
- 04 **Aisha:** State that the <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ has not been established. That is different from saying no legitimate purpose exists. We need context, not an accusation based on an empty explanatory field.
- 05 **Sam:** Should I call it harmless? I do not want to imply the concern has been dismissed.
- 06 **Aisha:** Preserve the <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ concern without choosing either outcome. Neutral wording can be precise about why review is needed while leaving the explanation open. It does not require us to pretend the difference is irrelevant.
- 07 **Sam:** The transaction records and profile are available. Any explanation we receive later should be distinguished from what the system already records.
- 08 **Aisha:** Maintain <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ for each item. Separate recorded transactions, customer information, and unverified explanations. Otherwise, a later reader may mistake an assertion or assumption for a fact established by the original records.
- 09 **Sam:** I will send the factual handoff to the authorized AML reviewer. Does the existence of an alert itself mean a report has been filed?
- 10 **Aisha:** No. A <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is separate from an alert. No reporting decision is recorded in this handoff. Do not infer filing or nonfiling status from the presence of T82 or from this review conversation.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Sam:** An unrelated colleague asked whether a SAR exists. Bank employment alone does not authorize that disclosure.
- 12 **Aisha:** Correct. Observe the <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ on SAR information, including whether a report exists. Employment alone does not create permission. Use the applicable authorized process for any request involving protected reporting information.
- 13 **Sam:** The customer-facing team may still need help with an ordinary service question. We should not put reporting information into a general customer note.
- 14 **Aisha:** Keep protected information in the appropriate <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Customer communication must follow its authorized process without revealing confidential reporting information. Do not use a convenient shared field as a shortcut around access restrictions.
- 15 **Sam:** I will retain the observed difference and the open business-purpose question. What should explain why the case is being escalated?
- 16 **Aisha:** Document the <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Tie it to relevant activity and missing context, not the customer's accent, nationality, or an impression of their personality. Those are not substitutes for evidence of wrongdoing.
- 17 **Sam:** I will list the alert, records, profile comparison, sources, and unresolved explanation, without asserting a criminal finding.
- 18 **Aisha:** That supports <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ through the approved process. Make clear what you observed and what assessment is still needed. Referral status must not be presented as an outcome that has already been reached.
- 19 **Sam:** When the authorized review is complete, its actual result can be recorded with the supporting rationale and the appropriate confidentiality controls.
- 20 **Aisha:** Yes. The <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ must reflect the completed assessment, not a guess made to clear the queue. Keep the evidence, review stage, and any protected reporting information distinct throughout the record.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. neutral description | 2. business purpose | 3. unusual activity | 4. source attribution | 5. reporting decision | 6. confidentiality restriction | 7. authorized channel | 8. review rationale | 9. case escalation | 10. alert disposition

# Complete a neutral alert handoff

## F Say it

Alert U19 identifies activity differing from a recorded profile. Its business purpose is unconfirmed. Noor owns the authorized review. No reporting decision is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

Noor / U19 / decision / unconfirmed

Analyst: "The alert reference is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Reviewer: "The business purpose remains <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Analyst: "The assigned reviewer is <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Reviewer: "This alert alone does not establish a reporting <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. U19 | 2. unconfirmed | 3. Noor | 4. decision

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# A checked condition points to the wrong agreement version

## A Read the situation

**Escalate a document mismatch without silently changing the evidence or authorizing a drawdown.**

Loan package L73 uses approved agreement version 3. The operations checklist marks condition C4 complete, but the attached supporting certificate refers to agreement version 2. The team has not established whether that certificate satisfies C4 for version 3. Operations officer Ravi and documentation reviewer Mae must correct the status and obtain an authorized assessment. Under the stated local process, the affected drawdown is not authorized while this condition remains unresolved. The mismatch alone does not prove that the entire loan is invalid. Neither participant may edit the certificate reference or mark the condition satisfied merely to meet a requested funding date.

PEOPLE / Ravi: Loan operations officer | Mae: Documentation reviewer

### A PRECISE CHALLENGE CAN PROTECT THE WORKING RELATIONSHIP

A checked box can be mistaken for an established fact, especially near a funding deadline. Identify the exact reference mismatch and its consequence for the current task. Challenge the evidence politely without accusing the preparer or claiming a wider legal conclusion.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

### 1. Which agreement version governs this package?

- |                                                          |                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> Version 2 because it appears on the certificate | <b>B</b> Any convenient previous draft |
| <b>C</b> An unidentified future version                  | <b>D</b> Approved version 3            |

### 2. What does the supporting certificate reference?

- |                              |                                      |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> Version 3           | <b>B</b> Every agreement ever issued |
| <b>C</b> No agreement at all | <b>D</b> Version 2                   |

### 3. What is the affected drawdown status under the stated process?

- |                                                      |                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> Permanently cancelled by this conversation  | <b>B</b> Not authorized while C4 remains unresolved |
| <b>C</b> Automatically authorized by the checked box | <b>D</b> Already paid in full                       |

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### loan facility

An agreed arrangement providing borrowing subject to specified terms.

**IN USE administer a loan facility**

### loan agreement

The contract establishing the borrowing terms and obligations.

**IN USE review the loan agreement**

### drawdown

Use or disbursement of funds under a loan facility.

**IN USE authorize a drawdown**

### condition precedent

A condition that must be satisfied or appropriately waived before a specified action.

**IN USE verify a condition precedent**

### supporting certificate

A document certifying specified information relevant to a requirement.

**IN USE examine a supporting certificate**

### approved version

The document issue authorized for the relevant purpose.

**IN USE identify the approved version**

### document discrepancy

A mismatch between documents or their references.

**IN USE record a document discrepancy**

### execution copy

The version prepared or used for formal signing.

**IN USE confirm the execution copy**

### executed document

A document signed or otherwise completed as required for its execution.

**IN USE retain the executed document**

### amendment

A documented change to an existing agreement.

**IN USE review an amendment**

### waiver

An authorized relinquishment or modification of a requirement under applicable terms.

**IN USE confirm a waiver**

### consent

Permission given by the relevant party for a specified action.

**IN USE obtain the required consent**

### Precision check

The certificate mismatch leaves C4 unresolved; it does not automatically invalidate the entire facility. Satisfaction, waiver, and release authorization are different decisions, each requiring its applicable authority and evidence.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### covenant

A contractual undertaking or restriction.

**IN USE monitor a covenant**

### security document

A document establishing or recording relevant collateral rights.

**IN USE verify the security document**

### collateral

Property or rights supporting repayment under an agreed arrangement.

**IN USE identify the collateral**

### guarantor

A party undertaking specified obligations relating to another party's debt.

**IN USE confirm the guarantor**

### facility agent

A party coordinating specified administrative functions under a facility agreement.

**IN USE contact the facility agent**

### conditions checklist

A record tracking requirements and their evidence or status.

**IN USE update the conditions checklist**

### document index

A list linking required documents to their identifiers and locations.

**IN USE maintain the document index**

### version control

Management of document issues and their applicable status.

**IN USE maintain version control**

### exception log

A record of unresolved departures or discrepancies.

**IN USE update the exception log**

### funding request

A request for a loan disbursement under the applicable arrangement.

**IN USE review the funding request**

### release authorization

Approval allowing a specified disbursement or action to proceed.

**IN USE verify release authorization**

### document retention

Preservation of records under the relevant requirements.

**IN USE follow document-retention requirements**

### Precision check

A requested funding date does not correct a document reference or authorize disbursement. Preserve the original certificate and obtain the required assessment. Do not silently replace version 2 with version 3 in the evidence.



# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

### NAME THE PACKAGE

"We are reviewing loan package L73."

### STATE THE CONFLICTING REFERENCE

"The certificate refers to version 2."

### CORRECT THE CHECKLIST

"C4 should not be marked complete on this evidence alone."

### LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"This mismatch does not by itself invalidate the whole loan."

### IDENTIFY THE APPROVED ISSUE

"The package uses agreement version 3."

### LOCATE THE AFFECTED CONDITION

"The mismatch concerns condition C4."

### PRESERVE THE DOCUMENT

"Do not edit the certificate reference."

### REQUEST AUTHORIZED REVIEW

"Please assess whether the certificate satisfies C4 for version 3."

---

### Refers to

Reports the actual document reference without deciding its legal effect.

### Should not be marked complete

Challenges a status unsupported by the supplied evidence.

### By itself

Limits the conclusion that follows from one observed mismatch.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

### KEEP FUNDING STATUS EXPLICIT

"The affected drawdown is not authorized while the condition remains unresolved."

### RESPECT THE DEADLINE WITHOUT INVENTING AUTHORITY

"I understand the requested funding date, but the evidence still needs review."

### AVOID ASSUMED EQUIVALENCE

"Similar wording does not prove that the documents are interchangeable."

### TRACK THE EXCEPTION

"Leave the discrepancy visible until its actual resolution is recorded."

### DISTINGUISH A WAIVER

"A request to overlook the issue is not an approved waiver."

### LINK THE REFERENCES

"Record the package, condition, and both version identifiers."

### KEEP THE NEXT ACTION CLEAR

"Obtain the relevant documentation decision through the authorized route."

### CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Report the reviewed evidence and authorization status separately."

---

### Satisfied versus waived

Meeting a condition differs from an authorized decision to waive it.

### Requested funding

A desired disbursement time, not evidence of permission.

### Separately

Prevents document review from being mistaken for release authorization.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which checklist correction is supported?

- A** Mark every loan condition permanently invalid.
- B** Leave C4 complete because funding is urgent.
- C** Mark C4 unresolved pending authorized assessment of the version mismatch.
- D** Change the certificate text without recording it.

### 2. Which statement invents a waiver?

- A** The certificate refers to version 2.
- B** The approved agreement is version 3.
- C** An authorized assessment is required.
- D** The client wants funding today, so C4 is waived.

### 3. What should happen to the original certificate?

- A** Treat it as proof of every other condition.
- B** Preserve it with its actual reference and obtain the necessary assessment.
- C** Silently replace its version number.
- D** Delete it so the mismatch cannot be seen.

### 4. What does resolving a document question not automatically establish?

- A** The existence of the original mismatch
- B** A separate release authorization unless the applicable process provides it
- C** The value of identifying correct versions
- D** The need to record the decision

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

# A checked condition points to the wrong agreement version

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

exception log / document index / funding request / release authorization / version control / waiver / supporting certificate / drawdown / condition precedent / document discrepancy

- 01 **Ravi:** C4 is checked complete in L73, but its certificate refers to agreement version 2. The approved package uses version 3.
- 02 **Mae:** Record the <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. We have not established whether that certificate satisfies C4 for version 3. A completed checkbox does not remove the conflicting reference or supply the missing assessment.
- 03 **Ravi:** Could the versions be equivalent for C4? I have not established their effect.
- 04 **Mae:** That needs authorized review of the <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and supporting evidence. Similar wording is not enough for us to declare satisfaction. Equally, the mismatch alone does not prove that the whole facility is invalid.
- 05 **Ravi:** The team wants funding today. Can I change the certificate's version number to match?
- 06 **Mae:** Preserve the <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ as received. Do not edit its reference to make the checklist look consistent. We need the relevant assessment and any properly issued replacement or other authorized resolution.
- 07 **Ravi:** I will correct the checklist status and note the exact package and condition. The requested funding date will remain a request, not an authorization.
- 08 **Mae:** Keep the <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ status explicit. Under this local process, the affected drawdown is not authorized while C4 remains unresolved. A deadline does not establish permission to release the funds.
- 09 **Ravi:** Someone suggested calling the issue waived because the client agrees to provide another certificate later. That does not sound like an authorized decision.
- 10 **Mae:** It is not an established <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Satisfaction and waiver are different concepts, and each needs its proper basis. We cannot convert the client's proposal into an approved waiver merely by changing the label.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Ravi:** I will send the document references to the appropriate reviewer. We should keep both versions available so the question can be assessed accurately.
- 12 **Mae:** Maintain <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Identify version 3 as the approved agreement and version 2 as the certificate's reference. That distinction lets the reviewer understand the actual issue instead of guessing which document we meant.
- 13 **Ravi:** Should the entry call the entire loan defective? That seems broader than this discrepancy.
- 14 **Mae:** Use the <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ to identify C4 and the pending assessment. Keep the scope precise. We have a document-reference question affecting a condition, not evidence that every part of the facility is defective.
- 15 **Ravi:** Once the reviewer decides what is needed, I will link that decision to the evidence. I will not remove the old certificate from the record.
- 16 **Mae:** Update the <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ so the decision and supporting material are traceable. If a replacement is issued, its identity and status need to be clear without erasing the document that prompted the question.
- 17 **Ravi:** Would satisfying or appropriately waiving C4 automatically authorize release of the funds?
- 18 **Mae:** Check the separate <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ requirements. Resolving this condition does not automatically establish every other required approval. Report the document decision and funding status separately so nobody infers permission from a narrower update.
- 19 **Ravi:** My handoff will show L73, C4, approved version 3, the certificate's version 2 reference, the unresolved status, and the authorized review request.
- 20 **Mae:** Good. Keep the <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ visible as well, but do not let its urgency replace the evidence. The next team needs the actual condition and authorization status, not a reassuring checkbox unsupported by the record.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. document discrepancy | 2. condition precedent | 3. supporting certificate | 4. drawdown | 5. waiver | 6. version control | 7. exception log | 8. document index | 9. release authorization | 10. funding request

# Identify another document mismatch

## F Say it

Package N26 uses approved agreement version 5. The certificate supporting condition D2 refers to version 4. Satisfaction is unresolved, and the affected drawdown is not authorized under the stated process.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

5 / D2 / N26 / 4

Officer: "The package reference is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Reviewer: "The approved agreement version is <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Officer: "The certificate refers to version <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Reviewer: "The affected condition is <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. N26 | 2. 5 | 3. 4 | 4. D2

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# Reviewed is not the same as resolved

## A Read the situation

04

**Give a payments-queue handoff with reconciled counts, clear stage labels, and no unsupported settlement claim.**

At 10:00 local time, a fixed queue snapshot contains 45 payment exceptions. Thirty have been reviewed: 24 are resolved under the queue process, and six await the required authorization. Fifteen have not yet been reviewed. There are no other categories in this snapshot. Supervisor Bea asks analyst Colin whether all items are resolved. Colin must report 24 resolved and 21 still open, while distinguishing the review rate from the resolution rate. A resolved queue exception does not itself confirm that the underlying payment has settled. The team will provide another status snapshot at 11:00; resolution of every item is not promised.

PEOPLE / Bea: Payments supervisor | Colin: Payments analyst

### GIVE THE DENOMINATOR WITH THE GOOD NEWS

A busy manager may hear thirty reviewed as thirty finished. State the full population and the mutually exclusive status groups. Recognize completed review work without letting a positive headline hide items that still need authorization or examination.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many exceptions are resolved?

A 30

B 45

C 15

D 24

2. How many exceptions remain open?

A 30

B 21

C 15

D 6

3. What does 11:00 represent?

A Guaranteed settlement of every payment

B Automatic authorization for six items

C A promise that every exception is resolved

D The next queue snapshot

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### payment instruction

A request specifying a transfer of funds.

**IN USE** validate a payment instruction

### payment rail

The system or network through which a payment is processed.

**IN USE** identify the payment rail

### Automated Clearing House (ACH)

A network supporting specified electronic credit and debit transfers.

**IN USE** process an ACH payment

### wire transfer

A funds transfer through the relevant wire-payment system.

**IN USE** track a wire transfer

### real-time gross settlement (RTGS)

Settlement of individual transfers in real time under the relevant system.

**IN USE** distinguish RTGS processing

### payment exception

An item requiring attention outside the normal processing path.

**IN USE** investigate a payment exception

### exception queue

A collection of payment items awaiting specified review or action.

**IN USE** monitor the exception queue

### queue snapshot

The queue's recorded status at a particular time.

**IN USE** timestamp the queue snapshot

### reviewed item

An item examined under the review process, possibly still unresolved.

**IN USE** count reviewed items

### resolved exception

An exception meeting the queue's defined resolution condition.

**IN USE** record a resolved exception

### pending authorization

A state awaiting required approval.

**IN USE** identify pending authorization

### unreviewed item

An item not yet examined under the stated process.

**IN USE** prioritize unreviewed items

### Precision check

Thirty reviewed out of 45 is approximately 66.7%; 24 resolved out of 45 is approximately 53.3%. The difference is six reviewed items awaiting authorization. Open items total 21, not just the 15 unreviewed.



# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### originator

The party initiating the payment under the relevant arrangement.

**IN USE identify the originator**

### beneficiary

The intended recipient of a payment.

**IN USE verify beneficiary details**

### routing information

Details directing the payment through the relevant institutions or system.

**IN USE validate routing information**

### value date

The date used for value or funds treatment under the relevant payment arrangement.

**IN USE confirm the value date**

### cut-off time

A deadline for a specified processing cycle or service.

**IN USE verify the cut-off time**

### payment release

The authorized sending of a payment to its next processing stage.

**IN USE confirm payment release**

### settlement

The discharge of the payment obligation through the relevant system.

**IN USE verify settlement status**

### return

A payment sent back under the applicable process.

**IN USE investigate a payment return**

### repair

Correction of a payment instruction through authorized procedures.

**IN USE route a payment repair**

### duplicate payment

A payment instruction or execution repeating another unintentionally or without the intended basis.

**IN USE review a possible duplicate payment**

### resolution rate

The proportion of the defined population meeting the resolution condition.

**IN USE calculate the resolution rate**

### review rate

The proportion of the defined population examined under the review process.

**IN USE calculate the review rate**

### Precision check

Resolved describes the queue exception under its stated process. It does not automatically mean released, received, or settled. Different payment rails and states require their actual evidence; this snapshot supplies no settlement confirmation.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 1 of 2

### TIMESTAMP THE REPORT

"This is the queue snapshot at 10:00 local time."

### STATE COMPLETED REVIEW

"Thirty items have been reviewed."

### NAME THE REMAINING REVIEWED ITEMS

"Six reviewed items await authorization."

### RECONCILE THE OPEN COUNT

"Twenty-one exceptions remain open."

### GIVE THE POPULATION

"There are 45 exceptions in this snapshot."

### SEPARATE THE RESOLVED GROUP

"Twenty-four are resolved under the queue process."

### STATE THE UNREVIEWED GROUP

"Fifteen have not yet been reviewed."

### EXPLAIN THE ARITHMETIC

"Six awaiting authorization plus fifteen unreviewed equals twenty-one."

### Of the thirty

Makes clear that resolved and awaiting-authorization groups are subsets of reviewed items.

### Still open

Includes more than the unreviewed portion of the queue.

### At 10:00

Restricts a count to its snapshot rather than a changing live total.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### **REPORT THE REVIEW RATE**

"The review rate is approximately 66.7%."

### **AVOID A SETTLEMENT CLAIM**

"Queue resolution does not confirm payment settlement."

### **AVOID SILENT RELABELING**

"Do not count reviewed items as resolved."

### **LIMIT THE COMMITMENT**

"That is a reporting time, not a promise to resolve every item."

### **REPORT THE RESOLUTION RATE**

"The resolution rate is approximately 53.3%."

### **KEEP AUTHORITY EXPLICIT**

"The six items still require the relevant authorization."

### **GIVE THE NEXT CONTACT**

"The next snapshot will be provided at 11:00."

### **CLOSE THE HANDOFF**

"Keep the counts and stage labels attached to the same timestamp."

---

### **Approximately**

Signals rounding of the stated ratios.

### **Resolved under the process**

Does not silently claim downstream settlement.

### **Next snapshot**

Promises refreshed information, not completed processing.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which breakdown reconciles to 45?

- A 24 resolved, six awaiting authorization, fifteen unreviewed
- B 30 resolved, six awaiting authorization, fifteen unreviewed
- C 24 resolved and fifteen open, with six omitted
- D 45 resolved and fifteen unreviewed

2. Which rate is approximately 66.7%?

- A Review rate
- B Resolution rate
- C Settlement rate
- D Return rate

3. Which statement improperly strengthens the evidence?

- A Twenty-four exceptions are resolved.
- B Six reviewed exceptions remain open.
- C Fifteen items are unreviewed.
- D All 24 underlying payments have settled because their exceptions are resolved.

4. What must the next report preserve?

- A A guarantee that authorization will occur by 11:00
- B A common timestamp, denominator, and distinct stage labels
- C The highest percentage without its definition
- D An invented settlement confirmation

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

# Reviewed is not the same as resolved

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

review rate / Pending authorization / settlement / resolved exception / unreviewed item / exception queue / payment release / cut-off time / resolution rate / queue snapshot

- 01 **Bea:** The report says thirty items reviewed. Can I tell the morning meeting that the exception queue is cleared?
- 02 **Colin:** No. The <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ contains forty-five items at ten hundred local time. Thirty were reviewed, but only twenty-four are resolved. Six reviewed items still await authorization, and fifteen remain unreviewed.
- 03 **Bea:** Then the thirty is a review count, not a completed-work count. We need to show the six separately.
- 04 **Colin:** Yes. <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is an open status here. Those six items cannot be called resolved simply because someone examined them. The review found another step that has not yet been completed.
- 05 **Bea:** How many exceptions are still open in total? I initially thought only the fifteen unreviewed items remained.
- 06 **Colin:** There are twenty-one. Each <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ belongs in the open group, along with the six awaiting authorization. Fifteen plus six gives twenty-one; counting only untouched items would understate the remaining work.
- 07 **Bea:** I want a clear percentage as well as counts. Thirty divided by forty-five is approximately sixty-six point seven percent.
- 08 **Colin:** That is the <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. The resolution rate uses twenty-four, not thirty, as the numerator. Both can be useful, but the label must match the status being counted.
- 09 **Bea:** Twenty-four divided by forty-five gives approximately fifty-three point three percent. We should not substitute the larger review percentage.
- 10 **Colin:** Correct. The <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ describes the queue's defined resolved state. It does not mean that the same percentage of all payment value has moved, because this snapshot counts items rather than money.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Bea:** Do the twenty-four resolved exceptions establish that those payments have reached their final destination? The meeting may ask about customer impact.
- 12 **Colin:** They do not establish <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Exception resolution and payment settlement are different states. We need the relevant payment records before making a statement about the underlying transfer's completion or customer receipt.
- 13 **Bea:** The six awaiting approval should remain visible. Could we move them into the resolved group because the necessary authorization is expected soon?
- 14 **Colin:** No. A <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ must meet the stated condition, not an expectation. Keep the approval dependency explicit until its actual status changes under the authorized process.
- 15 **Bea:** If we report a processing deadline, we should specify which system and stage it concerns. There is no universal time for every payment.
- 16 **Colin:** Exactly. A <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ belongs to a particular service or cycle. This snapshot gives no applicable cut-off or settlement confirmation, so we must not invent one to make the update sound complete.
- 17 **Bea:** Let us provide another snapshot at eleven hundred. That gives the team a clear next contact without promising that all items will disappear.
- 18 **Colin:** Agreed. We can report any verified <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ information separately if available. Eleven hundred is our next information update, not an authorization event or a guarantee that every open exception will be resolved.
- 19 **Bea:** My headline will say forty-five total, twenty-four resolved, six reviewed awaiting authorization, and fifteen unreviewed, all as of ten hundred.
- 20 **Colin:** That accurately describes the <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. The three exclusive groups reconcile to forty-five, and the open count is twenty-one. Keep those counts with the timestamp so readers do not combine this snapshot with a later number.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. queue snapshot | 2. Pending authorization | 3. unreviewed item | 4. review rate | 5. resolution rate | 6. settlement | 7. resolved exception | 8. cut-off time | 9. payment release | 10. exception queue

# Reconcile another queue snapshot

## F Say it

A fixed snapshot has 20 exceptions. Twelve are reviewed: nine resolved and three awaiting authorization. Eight are unreviewed. There are no other categories.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

60% / nine / eleven / 45%

Analyst: "The resolved count is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Supervisor: "The open count is <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Analyst: "The review rate is <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Supervisor: "The resolution rate is <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. nine | 2. eleven | 3. 60% | 4. 45%

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# Give one accurate explanation of the disputed-transaction process

## A Read the situation

**Correct conflicting service messages while separating dispute intake, investigation, temporary credit, and the final outcome.**

Customer June disputes a \$380 debit-card transaction posted on 7 September to her U.S. consumer account. The bank received her notice on 9 September. One agent told her to resolve it with the merchant first; another said a police report was required before an investigation could begin. Specialist Amir must correct those barriers under the applicable electronic-fund-transfer error-resolution process, preserve the original notice date, and identify the information still needed. No final finding or credit decision is supplied. Applicable investigation, provisional-credit, and notice requirements must be checked promptly; a later handoff does not restart the notice date or justify delay.

PEOPLE / June: Customer | Amir: Disputes specialist

### REPAIR THE PROCESS EXPLANATION BEFORE ADDING ANOTHER REQUEST

A customer who has heard contradictory instructions may distrust even an accurate next step. Acknowledge the conflict, preserve the original report, and explain which information genuinely helps the review. Do not make the customer repeat an unnecessary prerequisite to receive a consistent answer.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the original notice date?

A 9 September

C The date Amir happens to read the file

B 7 September

D A future date after merchant contact

2. Which barriers must Amir correct in this case?

A Checking applicable requirements promptly

C Recording the transaction amount

B Requiring merchant resolution or a police report before beginning the applicable investigation

D Preserving the original notice

3. What outcome has been established?

A A guaranteed permanent refund

C A final denial because she lacks a police report

B A confirmed finding that June authorized the transaction

D No final finding or credit decision is supplied.

Answers and explanations: page 84.



# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### electronic fund transfer (EFT)

A transfer of funds through electronic means within the applicable framework.

**IN USE identify the electronic fund transfer**

### Regulation E

A U.S. regulation implementing consumer electronic-fund-transfer protections.

**IN USE apply the relevant Regulation E process**

### unauthorized transaction

A transaction the customer did not make or permit, subject to the applicable definition.

**IN USE report an unauthorized transaction**

### disputed transaction

A transaction challenged by the customer for a stated reason.

**IN USE record the disputed transaction**

### notice of error

A customer's communication identifying an alleged error under the applicable process.

**IN USE preserve the notice of error**

### notice date

The date the relevant recipient received the error report.

**IN USE retain the original notice date**

### posting date

The date a transaction is recorded to the account.

**IN USE distinguish the posting date**

### merchant

The seller or service provider associated with a card transaction.

**IN USE identify the merchant**

### investigation

Examination of relevant facts to determine the dispute outcome.

**IN USE begin the applicable investigation**

### provisional credit

A temporary account credit while the relevant investigation continues.

**IN USE explain provisional credit**

### final credit

A credit made permanent under the completed decision.

**IN USE distinguish final credit**

### debit-card dispute

A challenge relating to a debit-card transaction.

**IN USE handle a debit-card dispute**

### Precision check

For this U.S. consumer electronic-transfer dispute, do not require merchant resolution or a police report before initiating the applicable investigation. Preserve the original 9 September notice; an internal handoff does not create a new notice date.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### error resolution

The process for investigating and addressing alleged account errors.

**IN USE follow error-resolution requirements**

### written confirmation

A written account confirming a previously reported matter when applicable.

**IN USE explain written-confirmation requirements**

### supporting information

Relevant details or records assisting the investigation.

**IN USE request supporting information**

### transaction descriptor

The displayed text identifying a transaction or merchant entry.

**IN USE check the transaction descriptor**

### case reference

The identifier assigned to the dispute or review.

**IN USE provide the case reference**

### handoff

Transfer of responsibility or information between service teams.

**IN USE document the handoff**

### interim update

A progress communication before the final decision.

**IN USE provide an interim update**

### final finding

The determination reached after the relevant investigation.

**IN USE explain the final finding**

### notification requirement

An obligation to communicate specified information under the applicable process.

**IN USE verify notification requirements**

### customer authentication

Verification of the customer's identity through the approved process.

**IN USE complete customer authentication**

### sensitive credential

Secret information used to access or authorize account activity.

**IN USE protect sensitive credentials**

### process correction

An action fixing an inaccurate instruction or handling step.

**IN USE record the process correction**

### Precision check

Provisional credit is temporary and is distinct from a final finding or permanent credit. Applicable requirements and timing must be checked promptly. This exercise does not create a universal deadline or make provisional credit discretionary when the law requires it.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 1 of 2

### ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONFLICT

"You received two different process explanations."

### PRESERVE THE NOTICE

"The bank received your report on 9 September."

### AVOID RESTARTING THE CLOCK

"This handoff does not change the original notice date."

### REQUEST RELEVANT FACTS

"Please confirm the transaction descriptor and what you dispute."

### CORRECT THE BARRIERS

"We should not make those prerequisites to initiating the applicable investigation."

### SEPARATE THE POSTING DATE

"The transaction posted on 7 September."

### IDENTIFY THE AMOUNT

"The disputed debit-card amount is \$380."

### AVOID REPEATED INTAKE

"I will check what the file already contains."

---

### Received on

Names the actual notice date rather than a later processing date.

### Before beginning

Identifies the improper barriers supplied by this case.

### Provisional

Temporary pending the relevant investigation and decision.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### KEEP AUTHENTICATION SAFE

"Use the approved verification process; do not share a PIN or one-time code here."

### SEPARATE TEMPORARY AND FINAL CREDIT

"Provisional credit does not establish the final outcome."

### RESPECT APPLICABLE REQUIREMENTS

"We need to check the investigation and credit requirements promptly."

### CORRECT THE RECORD

"Document the earlier conflicting instructions and the process correction."

### EXPLAIN THE REVIEW

"The investigation will assess the relevant facts."

### AVOID A PREMATURE GUARANTEE

"No permanent refund decision is supplied in the current record."

### EXPLAIN A REAL NEXT STEP

"I will identify the missing information and responsible review team."

### CLOSE CLEARLY

"Keep the original notice, investigation status, and credit status separate."

---

### Not supplied

Prevents an invented credit decision from entering the exercise.

### Promptly check

Does not authorize waiting indefinitely for internal convenience.

### Do not share

Protects secret credentials while allowing approved identity verification.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which message corrects the process?

- A** We will preserve your 9 September notice and not require those prerequisites to begin the applicable investigation.
- B** Your notice begins only after a police report.
- C** Merchant refusal automatically ends the bank's role.
- D** The handoff erases your original report date.

### 2. What does provisional credit mean?

- A** Permission to ignore investigation requirements
- B** Temporary credit distinct from a final decision
- C** A guaranteed permanent refund in every case
- D** Proof that the customer committed fraud

### 3. Which date is the posting date?

- A** No date is supplied
- B** 7 September
- C** 9 September
- D** The handoff date

### 4. Which request should Amir avoid?

- A** Reviewing information already in the file
- B** Asking June to disclose a PIN or one-time code in this conversation
- C** Asking what transaction she disputes
- D** Checking the recorded descriptor

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

# Give one accurate explanation of the disputed-transaction process

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

transaction descriptor / Provisional credit / Customer authentication / unauthorized transaction / handoff / interim update / process correction / error resolution / notice date / written confirmation

- 01 **June:** I reported the three-hundred-eighty-dollar debit on September ninth. One agent said to resolve it with the merchant; another demanded a police report.
- 02 **Amir:** Those conflicting instructions need a <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. For this consumer electronic-transfer dispute, we should not require merchant resolution or a police report before beginning the applicable investigation. I will record and correct that explanation.
- 03 **June:** The charge posted on September seventh. Does your involvement today mean my report date changes to today?
- 04 **Amir:** No. We must preserve the original <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ of September ninth. September seventh is the posting date. An internal transfer between teams does not change when the bank received your notice or justify restarting the process.
- 05 **June:** I can confirm the amount and displayed merchant description. Please check what is already in the file before asking me to repeat everything.
- 06 **Amir:** I will review the <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and your recorded explanation. We need relevant missing information. A familiar merchant name alone does not answer the dispute.
- 07 **June:** I did not make or permit this transaction. Will you record that without assuming the result before the investigation?
- 08 **Amir:** Yes. We will record the alleged <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and investigate the relevant facts. We must consider your report properly. The file contains no final finding.
- 09 **June:** Another message mentioned temporary credit. Does that mean the bank has already decided to give me the money permanently?
- 10 **Amir:** <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is different from a final credit or finding. We need to check the applicable credit requirements and timing promptly. Required protections are not optional.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **June:** I understand that the outcome is open, but I need the team to follow the correct timetable rather than leave the case pending indefinitely.
- 12 **Amir:** Agreed. The applicable <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ process governs investigation, credit, and communication requirements. We must check the actual case conditions and original notice date rather than replace them with a convenient internal target.
- 13 **June:** Please explain any written-confirmation requirement clearly. Another vague instruction should not block the investigation.
- 14 **Amir:** Any <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ request must be explained accurately under the applicable process. It should identify what is needed and its significance, without recreating the improper police-report or merchant-resolution prerequisite you were given.
- 15 **June:** Before discussing account details, I will use the bank's verified service route. I will not share a PIN or one-time code in this conversation.
- 16 **Amir:** Correct. <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ must follow the approved process. Protect sensitive credentials and use the verified channel for any relevant documents. This message does not need secret access details.
- 17 **June:** Please tell the next team about the original notice and the conflicting advice. I do not want the same barriers repeated after another transfer.
- 18 **Amir:** I will document the <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ with those facts and the remaining information needs. The next reviewer should see the amount, posting date, notice date, reported concern, and process correction without having to reconstruct the conversation.
- 19 **June:** Then an update will tell me the actual review and credit status, rather than imply that either temporary credit or a new contact decides the outcome.
- 20 **Amir:** Exactly. An <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ should explain the actual status and next step. Keep investigation, provisional credit, and the final decision distinct, and make sure communication follows the applicable requirements rather than another unsupported promise.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. process correction | 2. notice date | 3. transaction descriptor | 4. unauthorized transaction | 5. Provisional credit | 6. error resolution | 7. written confirmation | 8. Customer authentication | 9. handoff | 10. interim update

# Preserve another original notice

## F Say it

A consumer disputes a \$240 debit-card transaction posted on 2 May. The bank received notice on 4 May. A later internal handoff occurs on 6 May. No final finding is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

2 May / 4 May / 6 May / 240

Specialist: "The disputed amount is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Customer: "The posting date was <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Specialist: "The original notice date remains <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Customer: "The internal handoff occurred on <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. 240 | 2. 2 May | 3. 4 May | 4. 6 May

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.



# A sign-off cannot erase an unmatched balance

## A Read the situation

**Explain a reconciliation break, correct a misleading control status, and preserve evidence for the next reviewer.**

06

The 30 June reconciliation shows a \$250,000 general-ledger balance and a \$248,750 subledger balance on the same stated basis, leaving a \$1,250 difference. The cause is unconfirmed. A control record has been signed as fully reconciled, although the unmatched item remains under investigation. Analyst Tess and controller Omar must correct that description through the traceable review process. The local procedure permits a reviewer to acknowledge a documented open exception, but not to label an unresolved difference fully matched. No journal adjustment or write-off has been approved. A timing difference is only one possible explanation, not an established fact.

PEOPLE / Tess: Reconciliation analyst | Omar: Operations controller

### DESCRIBE THE CONTROL STATE INSTEAD OF DEFENDING THE SIGNATURE

A signed record can make a colleague reluctant to raise a remaining difference. Separate acknowledgment of work performed from confirmation that all items match. A precise correction protects the record without assuming misconduct by the person who signed it.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the unmatched amount?

A \$248,750

B \$2,500

C \$1,250

D \$250,000

2. What is established about the cause?

A It is an approved write-off.

B It remains unconfirmed.

C It is definitely a timing difference.

D It is proven fraud.

3. What does the local procedure allow?

A A balancing journal without approval

B Acknowledgment of a documented open exception without calling it fully matched

C An unsupported fully reconciled label

D Automatic write-off of every small difference

Answers and explanations: page 86.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### general ledger (GL)

The main accounting record of balances and entries.

**IN USE** reconcile the general ledger

### subledger

A detailed record supporting a general-ledger balance.

**IN USE** compare the subledger

### reconciliation

Comparison of records to identify and explain differences.

**IN USE** perform a reconciliation

### reconciling item

A difference requiring explanation or resolution between compared records.

**IN USE** investigate a reconciling item

### unmatched balance

An amount not yet matched or explained on the comparison basis.

**IN USE** report an unmatched balance

### timing difference

A difference arising from when related events are recorded, if established.

**IN USE** substantiate a timing difference

### journal entry

An accounting entry recording a transaction or adjustment.

**IN USE** review a journal entry

### adjustment

A change to accounting records under the appropriate basis and authority.

**IN USE** authorize an adjustment

### write-off

Removal of a recorded amount under the applicable accounting decision.

**IN USE** approve a write-off

### supporting schedule

A detailed record explaining a reported balance.

**IN USE** retain the supporting schedule

### control sign-off

A recorded review or approval with a specified meaning.

**IN USE** qualify the control sign-off

### preparer

The person producing a record or reconciliation.

**IN USE** identify the preparer

### Precision check

The \$1,250 difference is established; its cause is not. Calling it a timing difference requires evidence. Neither the amount nor the existence of a signature authorizes an adjustment, write-off, or fully matched conclusion.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### reviewer

The person checking the work under the relevant process.

**IN USE identify the reviewer**

### segregation of duties

Separation of incompatible responsibilities to reduce risk.

**IN USE maintain segregation of duties**

### maker-checker control

A process in which one person prepares and another independently checks the relevant action.

**IN USE apply a maker-checker control**

### control exception

A departure or unresolved condition identified in a control process.

**IN USE document a control exception**

### exception aging

The length of time an unresolved item has remained open.

**IN USE monitor exception aging**

### root-cause analysis

Examination of the underlying reason for a problem.

**IN USE conduct root-cause analysis**

### control deficiency

A weakness in control design or operation under the relevant assessment.

**IN USE assess a control deficiency**

### operational loss

Loss arising from relevant operational events or failures.

**IN USE record an operational loss**

### audit trail

Records allowing an action or decision to be traced.

**IN USE preserve the audit trail**

### reperformance

Independently repeating a procedure to evaluate its result.

**IN USE arrange reperformance**

### evidence reference

A link or identifier connecting a conclusion to supporting material.

**IN USE add an evidence reference**

### resolution owner

The person accountable for coordinating an item's resolution.

**IN USE assign a resolution owner**

### Precision check

A reviewer may acknowledge an open exception under this stated local process, but the record must describe that status honestly. Correcting the label is different from resolving the underlying difference, and both need their own evidence.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### STATE THE COMPARISON

"The ledger shows \$250,000 and the subledger \$248,750."

### CALCULATE THE DIFFERENCE

"The unmatched amount is \$1,250."

### AVOID A CONVENIENT LABEL

"Timing is a possible explanation, not an established one."

### RECOGNIZE PERMITTED ACKNOWLEDGMENT

"The reviewer can acknowledge a documented open exception."

### CONFIRM THE BASIS

"Both balances use the same stated comparison basis."

### PRESERVE THE UNKNOWN

"The cause has not been confirmed."

### CORRECT THE CONTROL DESCRIPTION

"Fully reconciled is not supported while this difference remains unexplained."

### SEPARATE CORRECTION AND RESOLUTION

"Fixing the label does not resolve the balance difference."

06

---

### Fully reconciled

Claims a completed match or explanation that this case lacks.

### Acknowledged with exception

Can describe the local permitted review without hiding the difference.

### Possible versus confirmed

Separates an explanation to investigate from an established cause.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 2 of 2

### PROTECT THE EVIDENCE

"Preserve the original record and correction history."

### KEEP AUTHORITY EXPLICIT

"A write-off requires its applicable basis and authorization."

### KEEP THE ITEM VISIBLE

"Record the amount and status in the exception log."

### DISTINGUISH ROLES

"Preparation and independent review are separate responsibilities."

### AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED ENTRY

"No balancing adjustment has been approved."

### NAME RESPONSIBILITY

"Assign the resolution owner and next review step."

### LINK THE SUPPORT

"Attach the relevant ledger and subledger references."

### CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Report the open difference and qualified review status together."

06

---

### Balancing entry

Must not be used merely to make unexplained records agree.

### Corrected label

Changes the record's description, not the underlying balance.

### Same basis

Ensures the subtraction compares like figures.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which control description is accurate?

- A** Fully matched with no unresolved items
- B** Written off because the amount is inconvenient
- C** Proven fraud based only on the difference
- D** Reviewed with an open \$1,250 exception; cause under investigation

### 2. Which action is unsupported?

- A** Assign a resolution owner.
- B** Post an unapproved \$1,250 adjustment solely to force agreement.
- C** Preserve both balance records.
- D** Correct the misleading status traceably.

### 3. What is needed before calling this a timing difference?

- A** Evidence establishing the timing explanation
- B** Only a preference for that label
- C** A signature with no supporting record
- D** A lower amount after guessing

### 4. Which statement distinguishes two tasks correctly?

- A** Changing the label automatically changes the balances.
- B** Keeping an exception log proves the cause.
- C** A review signature replaces every missing record.
- D** Correcting the sign-off description does not itself resolve the underlying balance.

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

# A sign-off cannot erase an unmatched balance

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

timing difference / audit trail / resolution owner / journal entry / write-off / segregation of duties / unmatched balance / control exception / control sign-off / evidence reference

- 01 **Tess:** The June thirtieth record says fully reconciled, but the ledger shows two hundred fifty thousand and the subledger two hundred forty-eight thousand seven hundred fifty.
- 02 **Omar:** That leaves an <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ of twelve hundred fifty dollars. We must preserve that difference in the record. The signature does not establish that it has been explained or resolved.
- 03 **Tess:** The analyst thought it might be a posting-date issue. We do not yet have the records needed to confirm that explanation.
- 04 **Omar:** Then do not call it a confirmed <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. It is a possibility to investigate. A plausible explanation can guide the next check without becoming the stated cause before the evidence supports it.
- 05 **Tess:** Our procedure lets a reviewer acknowledge work with a documented exception. It does not permit calling every balance matched when one remains unresolved.
- 06 **Omar:** Correct the <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ accordingly. Reviewed with an open exception is different from fully reconciled. We should describe the permitted review state without using the signature to hide the unfinished item.
- 07 **Tess:** I will preserve the original signed record and document the correction. The status change should not silently remove the earlier wording.
- 08 **Omar:** Maintain the <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Explain why the description changed and retain the supporting references. Correcting a misleading label improves the record, but it does not itself resolve the accounting difference.
- 09 **Tess:** A colleague suggested an adjustment for the difference so the balances agree. There is no approved basis for that entry.
- 10 **Omar:** Do not create a <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ simply to force agreement. Any actual adjustment needs its proper evidence and authority. Otherwise, the apparent match would conceal an unexplained item rather than provide a valid reconciliation.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Tess:** Nor can we write it off just because it is smaller than the full account balance. The amount alone does not provide approval.
- 12 **Omar:** Exactly. A <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ requires its applicable basis and authorization. Neither has been established. Keep the difference open while the relevant records are examined, rather than selecting a convenient accounting outcome.
- 13 **Tess:** Who should coordinate the outstanding work? The file needs a clear person responsible, not merely a general note saying someone will investigate.
- 14 **Omar:** Assign the <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ through the local process and record the next review step. Ownership, evidence gathering, and resolution are separate facts; an assigned name should not be mistaken for a closed issue.
- 15 **Tess:** We can link the ledger extract and detailed balance schedule. The next reviewer should see the actual amounts without reconstructing them from our conversation.
- 16 **Omar:** Add an <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ for each. Preserve the common comparison basis as well. If the balances come from different dates or scopes, that would be a different question requiring its own explanation.
- 17 **Tess:** The comparison basis matches. The root cause remains unconfirmed.
- 18 **Omar:** Keep the <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ visible with its amount and status. The control can acknowledge the exception honestly under the stated procedure; it cannot claim that no exception exists.
- 19 **Tess:** The corrected handoff will show the twelve-hundred-fifty-dollar difference, unconfirmed cause, no approved adjustment, and review acknowledgment with the exception still open.
- 20 **Omar:** Good. Preserve <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ as the work proceeds. Independent review and any authorized accounting decision must follow the applicable roles. A cleaner-looking balance is not a substitute for an explained and properly approved outcome.

06

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. unmatched balance | 2. timing difference | 3. control sign-off | 4. audit trail | 5. journal entry | 6. write-off | 7. resolution owner | 8. evidence reference | 9. control exception | 10. segregation of duties



# Describe a second reconciliation break

## F Say it

A same-basis comparison shows a \$90,000 ledger balance and an \$89,600 subledger balance. The cause is unknown. No adjustment is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

unknown / 400 / 90,000 / 89,600

Analyst: "The ledger balance is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Reviewer: "The subledger balance is <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Analyst: "The unmatched difference is <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Reviewer: "The cause remains <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. 90,000 | 2. 89,600 | 3. 400 | 4. unknown

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# A policy describes the control but does not prove it operated

## **A** Read the situation

**Respond to an evidence request with exact scope, honest availability, and traceable period coverage.**

An examiner requests evidence that control R9 operated during March, including records for 3, 10, 17, 24, and 31 March. Coordinator Liv has policy version 2 ready. She has also retrieved completed records for 10 and 24 March; records for the other three requested dates have not yet been located. The absence of retrieved records does not by itself establish whether the control failed or operated. Control owner Yusuf will help locate the evidence and report retrieval status Wednesday at 13:00. Liv must distinguish policy design from operating evidence and must not recreate historical sign-offs as if they were original.

PEOPLE / Liv: Examination coordinator | Yusuf: Control owner

07

### **A TRANSPARENT EVIDENCE GAP IS BETTER THAN A MISLEADING PACKAGE**

Teams may feel pressure to answer an examination request with whatever looks complete. Map the request to the exact dates and evidence types. A clear account of what is available and missing helps the reviewer understand the actual record without a fabricated claim of completeness.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

**1.** How many requested dated records are retrieved?

- |                        |                       |
|------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>A</b> Two of five   | <b>B</b> Five of five |
| <b>C</b> Three of five | <b>D</b> None         |

**2.** What does policy version 2 primarily describe?

- |                                                          |                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> A completed examiner conclusion                 | <b>B</b> A substitute for every historical sign-off   |
| <b>C</b> The control's documented design or requirements | <b>D</b> Proof of performance on every requested date |

**3.** What can be concluded about the three unlocated records?

- |                                                                                          |                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> Their retrieval is incomplete; operation is not established by that fact alone. | <b>B</b> The control definitely failed on all three dates.  |
| <b>C</b> The control definitely operated correctly.                                      | <b>D</b> The records may be invented to finish the package. |

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### regulatory examination

A supervisory review by the relevant regulatory authority.

**IN USE coordinate a regulatory examination**

### examination request

A request for records or explanation within an examination.

**IN USE respond to an examination request**

### request reference

The identifier linking a request to the response and evidence.

**IN USE retain the request reference**

### control design

The planned structure and requirements of a control.

**IN USE explain control design**

### operating effectiveness

Whether a control actually functions as intended over the relevant basis.

**IN USE assess operating effectiveness**

### population

The full set of items relevant to a defined review.

**IN USE define the review population**

### sample selection

The items chosen from the relevant population for examination.

**IN USE confirm the sample selection**

### review period

The dates covered by the requested assessment.

**IN USE identify the review period**

### dated evidence

A record tied to an identifiable time or event.

**IN USE provide dated evidence**

### execution record

Documentation that a specified activity was performed.

**IN USE retrieve the execution record**

### reviewer sign-off

A record of the reviewer's check or approval under the process.

**IN USE verify the reviewer sign-off**

### evidence inventory

A list of requested, available, and outstanding supporting records.

**IN USE maintain an evidence inventory**

### Precision check

Two retrieved records out of five requested dates is 40% retrieval coverage for that request. It is not a 40% control-effectiveness score, and it does not establish a conclusion about every day in March.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### evidence gap

Missing support for a requested fact or conclusion.

**IN USE disclose an evidence gap**

### retrieval status

The stage of locating and obtaining records.

**IN USE report retrieval status**

### record custodian

The person or function responsible for keeping the relevant records.

**IN USE contact the record custodian**

### walkthrough

A guided examination of how a process is designed or carried out.

**IN USE conduct a process walkthrough**

### test of control

A procedure assessing relevant control design or operation.

**IN USE perform a test of control**

### period coverage

The extent to which evidence represents the required time interval.

**IN USE assess period coverage**

### contemporaneous record

A record created at or near the time of the relevant event.

**IN USE preserve a contemporaneous record**

### retrospective explanation

A later account describing a past event or missing record.

**IN USE label a retrospective explanation**

### evidence mapping

Linking each request item to its supporting record.

**IN USE complete evidence mapping**

### response package

The organized material submitted in reply to a request.

**IN USE assemble the response package**

### examiner conclusion

The outcome reached by the examiner's assessment.

**IN USE distinguish the examiner conclusion**

### management representation

A statement by management about a matter under review.

**IN USE qualify a management representation**

### Precision check

A later explanation can be useful if clearly labeled and supported, but it is not an original historical sign-off. Preserve dates, authorship, and the distinction between contemporaneous evidence and a retrospective account.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 1 of 2

### RESTATE THE REQUEST

"The examiner requested R9 evidence for five specified March dates."

### SEPARATE DESIGN AND OPERATION

"The policy describes requirements; it does not prove each execution."

### NAME THE MISSING DATES

"Records for 3, 17, and 31 March are not yet located."

### AVOID A PERFORMANCE SCORE

"That is not a control-effectiveness percentage."

### IDENTIFY THE POLICY

"Policy version 2 is available."

### STATE RETRIEVED RECORDS

"We have the records for 10 and 24 March."

### QUANTIFY ONLY WHAT IS MEASURED

"Retrieval coverage is two of five requested records."

### PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"Missing retrieved evidence does not by itself prove performance or failure."

### Available policy

Describes a document's presence, not actual control performance.

### For five dates

Limits the requested sample rather than implying every March day.

### Not yet located

Names retrieval status without asserting that the activity never happened.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### MAP THE PACKAGE

"Link each requested date to its actual evidence."

### PROTECT HISTORICAL ACCURACY

"Do not create a later sign-off as though it were original."

### STATE THE NEXT CONTACT

"Retrieval status will be updated Wednesday at 13:00."

### KEEP THE CONCLUSION SEPARATE

"The examiner's assessment is not ours to invent."

### CONTACT THE CUSTODIAN

"Yusuf will help locate the outstanding records."

### LABEL LATER EXPLANATIONS

"Identify any retrospective account by author, date, and basis."

### LIMIT THE COMMITMENT

"That is an update time, not a guarantee all records will be found."

### CLOSE THE RESPONSE

"Submit the available evidence with an accurate inventory of outstanding items."

---

### Forty percent retrieved

Measures record availability for this request, not effectiveness.

### Retrospective

A later explanation must not masquerade as a contemporaneous entry.

### Examiner conclusion

Belongs to the actual assessment, not a self-awarded status label.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which package description is accurate?

- A** Five original sign-offs reconstructed today
- B** Policy version 2 plus records for 10 and 24 March; three requested dates outstanding
- C** Complete evidence for every March day
- D** Proof of failure on three dates

### 2. What is the retrieval coverage?

- A** 40% of the five requested dated records
- B** 40% control effectiveness for all March
- C** 60% completed examiner approval
- D** 100% because the policy is available

### 3. Which action would misrepresent the evidence?

- A** Identify the three unlocated dates.
- B** Create today's sign-off and present it as an original March record.
- C** Label a later explanation with its actual date.
- D** Preserve the available records.

### 4. What should Yusuf report Wednesday if records remain missing?

- A** The actual retrieval status and outstanding dates
- B** That all controls passed because the appointment occurred
- C** A guessed examiner conclusion
- D** An invented historical signature

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

# A policy describes the control but does not prove it operated

## **E** Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

contemporaneous record / Operating effectiveness / evidence inventory / record custodian / evidence gap / retrospective explanation / retrieval status / evidence mapping / examiner conclusion / control design

07

- 01 **Liv:** The examiner wants R9 records for March third, tenth, seventeenth, twenty-fourth, and thirty-first. I have policy version 2 ready.
- 02 **Yusuf:** The policy describes <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_, but the request also needs operating evidence. We must distinguish the intended procedure from records showing what actually happened on each requested date.
- 03 **Liv:** I found records for the tenth and twenty-fourth. The other three are not yet located.
- 04 **Yusuf:** Put that in the <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. We have two requested dated records, not five. Keep the available records and missing dates visible rather than describing the package as complete because a policy document is attached.
- 05 **Liv:** That gives two out of five, or forty percent retrieval coverage. I should not call it a forty-percent effectiveness result.
- 06 **Yusuf:** Correct. <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is a different assessment. Record availability for this request does not establish the control's success rate, and the five selected dates do not automatically represent every day in March.
- 07 **Liv:** Do the missing records prove the control was not performed on those dates? I want to avoid minimizing the gap.
- 08 **Yusuf:** They establish an <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_, not the full explanation. We must investigate and report it honestly. Do not assume performance, but do not claim failure solely because the record has not yet been located.
- 09 **Liv:** I will map each requested date to the available file or outstanding status. That should help the examiner see what the response actually contains.
- 10 **Yusuf:** Use <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ with the relevant references. Check that each file belongs to the requested control and date. A similarly named record from another period is not a substitute merely because it is available.



# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Liv:** Who can help find the outstanding files? I have checked the shared folder but have not established whether another authorized repository holds them.
- 12 **Yusuf:** I will coordinate with the <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. We need the actual retention and storage context, not a guess. Any retrieval route must preserve the records and follow the applicable access requirements.
- 13 **Liv:** Someone suggested new sign-offs with March dates to make the set look finished.
- 14 **Yusuf:** Do not present a new entry as a <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. A later sign-off cannot be passed off as an original March record. We need accurate creation dates, authorship, and the actual basis of any later account.
- 15 **Liv:** A reviewer might remember performing the check. Could a clearly dated explanation help, even though it is not the original execution record?
- 16 **Yusuf:** A <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ can be evaluated for what it is. Identify its author, date, and supporting basis. Do not imply it has the same origin as the missing historical document or automatically resolves the request.
- 17 **Liv:** Wednesday at thirteen hundred is a retrieval update, not a guarantee that every record will be found.
- 18 **Yusuf:** Correct. The <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ update will name any remaining gaps. If we cannot locate a record, we must say so clearly and follow the authorized response process rather than manufacture completeness.
- 19 **Liv:** The package will include the policy, two dated records, a mapped list of the three outstanding dates, and any properly labeled later explanation.
- 20 **Yusuf:** Good. Keep the <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ separate from our submission status. Providing a transparent package supports the review, but it does not mean the examiner has accepted the evidence or concluded that the control operated effectively.

07

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. control design | 2. evidence inventory | 3. Operating effectiveness | 4. evidence gap | 5. evidence mapping | 6. record custodian | 7. contemporaneous record | 8. retrospective explanation | 9. retrieval status | 10. examiner conclusion

# Map another evidence request

## F Say it

An examiner requests four April records. Three are retrieved; one remains unlocated. The current policy is available. A retrieval update is due Friday.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

Friday / four / 75% / three

Coordinator: "The number of requested dated records is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Owner: "The number retrieved is <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Coordinator: "Retrieval coverage is <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Owner: "The next retrieval update is due <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. four | 2. three | 3. 75% | 4. Friday

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# The current fee schedule may not explain a past charge

## A Read the situation

**Investigate a historical fee question using the applicable period, product, transaction, and waiver conditions.**

Customer Priya asks about a \$15 maintenance charge for the June statement cycle. Representative Daniel has a current fee schedule effective 1 August showing a \$10 maintenance fee for a particular account product. He has not checked which product Priya held in June, the terms effective for that cycle, or whether any waiver condition applied. He cannot yet establish whether the \$15 charge was correct or whether a refund is due. Daniel will obtain the relevant account and historical fee records and update Priya Tuesday at 15:00. The current schedule must not be applied retroactively merely because it is the first document available.

PEOPLE / Priya: Customer | Daniel: Customer-service representative

08

### TAKE THE QUESTION SERIOUSLY BEFORE DEFENDING THE CHARGE

A representative may reach for the current schedule because it is convenient. Restate the actual charge and period, then check the terms that applied. Acknowledge uncertainty without dismissing the complaint or promising a refund before the relevant records are examined.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What charge is disputed?

- |                                                       |                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> A \$150 transfer fee                         | <b>B</b> An already approved refund     |
| <b>C</b> A \$15 maintenance charge for the June cycle | <b>D</b> A confirmed \$10 August charge |

2. What is the effective date of Daniel's available schedule?

- |                                         |                              |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> 1 August                       | <b>B</b> 1 June              |
| <b>C</b> Every prior year automatically | <b>D</b> No date is supplied |

3. What remains unchecked?

- |                                                                            |                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> June product, applicable historical terms, and waiver eligibility | <b>B</b> Only the color of the statement       |
| <b>C</b> Whether Tuesday is a weekday                                      | <b>D</b> The existence of the current schedule |

Answers and explanations: page 90.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### **maintenance fee**

A recurring account charge under the applicable terms.

**IN USE review a maintenance fee**

### **fee schedule**

A document listing charges and their conditions.

**IN USE check the fee schedule**

### **effective date**

The date from which specified terms apply.

**IN USE confirm the effective date**

### **statement cycle**

The period covered by a periodic account statement.

**IN USE identify the statement cycle**

### **account product**

The specific type or version of account held by a customer.

**IN USE verify the account product**

### **historical terms**

The terms applicable during a past relevant period.

**IN USE retrieve historical terms**

### **waiver condition**

A requirement that, if met under the terms, removes or reduces a charge.

**IN USE assess a waiver condition**

### **minimum balance**

A required balance threshold under a specified measure and period.

**IN USE check the minimum-balance condition**

### **average daily balance**

A balance measure averaging daily balances over a defined period.

**IN USE calculate average daily balance**

### **qualifying deposit**

A deposit meeting the specified conditions for a benefit or waiver.

**IN USE identify a qualifying deposit**

### **billing period**

The interval to which charges are attributed.

**IN USE confirm the billing period**

### **posting entry**

A recorded account transaction or charge.

**IN USE trace the posting entry**

### **Precision check**

The current \$10 schedule does not prove the June charge should have been \$10. Its effective date is 1 August, and its product coverage still needs checking. A \$5 difference alone does not establish a refund.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### account conversion

A change from one account product or arrangement to another.

**IN USE** review an account conversion

### change notice

Communication of altered terms under the applicable process.

**IN USE** retrieve the change notice

### fee assessment

The application of a charge under specified rules and facts.

**IN USE** examine the fee assessment

### eligibility

Whether conditions for a particular term or benefit are met.

**IN USE** verify waiver eligibility

### retroactive application

Applying terms to a period before their stated applicability.

**IN USE** question retroactive application

### historical schedule

The charge schedule applicable to a past period.

**IN USE** obtain the historical schedule

### service record

Documentation of customer contacts and actions.

**IN USE** update the service record

### complaint reference

An identifier linking a complaint to its handling record.

**IN USE** provide a complaint reference

### refund decision

A determination about returning a charged amount.

**IN USE** explain the refund decision

### account credit

An entry increasing or offsetting the customer's account balance as applicable.

**IN USE** verify an account credit

### case resolution

The supported outcome and completion status of a customer case.

**IN USE** document case resolution

### further review

Additional examination through the applicable process.

**IN USE** explain further-review options

### Precision check

A waiver may depend on a specific balance measure, deposit type, or other condition. Do not substitute an end-of-month balance for an average-daily-balance requirement or assume every deposit qualifies. Use the actual applicable terms.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### RESTATE THE CHARGE

"You are asking about the \$15 maintenance charge for June."

### LIMIT ITS USE

"That schedule does not automatically explain the June charge."

### FIND THE APPLICABLE TERMS

"We will retrieve the fee schedule effective for June."

### AVOID A PREMATURE DEFENSE

"I have not established that the charge was correct."

### NAME THE AVAILABLE DOCUMENT

"I have a schedule effective from 1 August."

### CHECK THE PRODUCT

"I need to confirm the account product held during that cycle."

### REVIEW THE WAIVER

"We also need to check whether a waiver condition applied."

### AVOID A PREMATURE REFUND

"The \$5 difference does not by itself establish a refund."

08

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### Effective from

Establishes when terms apply, not every earlier period.

### For June

Connects the complaint to its actual statement cycle.

### Held during

Recognizes that the product may have changed over time.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### SEPARATE BALANCE MEASURES

"The relevant balance measure depends on the actual terms."

### CHECK DISCLOSURE

"Retrieve the relevant change notice if the terms changed."

### GIVE THE NEXT CONTACT

"I will update you Tuesday at 15:00."

### KEEP THE COMPLAINT OPEN

"The fee question remains unresolved."

### PRESERVE THE HISTORY

"An account conversion may affect which product terms apply."

### MAKE THE NEXT STEP CONCRETE

"I will obtain the historical account and fee records."

### LIMIT THE APPOINTMENT

"That is a review update, not a guaranteed credit date."

### CLOSE WITH ACCOUNTABILITY

"The response will explain the applicable period, product, and basis for the outcome."

08

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### Whether a waiver applied

Requires evidence of eligibility, not an assumed benefit.

### Difference versus error

Two different amounts do not automatically prove a billing mistake.

### Update versus credit

A communication appointment does not establish an account adjustment.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which first reply is accurate?

- A** Today's \$10 schedule proves you are owed \$5.
- B** Every \$15 fee is automatically correct.
- C** The complaint is invalid because the schedule changed.
- D** I will check the June product, historical terms, and waiver conditions before deciding the charge.

### 2. Why does the 1 August date matter?

- A** It guarantees every June fee was waived.
- B** It proves Priya held the same product in June.
- C** It is irrelevant to every fee question.
- D** It limits the current schedule's applicability and does not automatically establish June terms.

### 3. Which waiver assumption is unsupported?

- A** The account product needs confirmation.
- B** Different balance measures can produce different results.
- C** Any deposit automatically satisfies every qualifying-deposit condition.
- D** The applicable waiver wording needs review.

### 4. What should Tuesday's update do if the review remains incomplete?

- A** Identify the actual outstanding records and review status.
- B** Invent a refund approval to meet the appointment.
- C** Apply the current schedule retroactively without review.
- D** Close the complaint because one response was sent.

Answers and explanations: [page 90](#).



# The current fee schedule may not explain a past charge

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

Average daily balance / statement cycle / refund decision / waiver condition / case resolution / historical terms / account product / service record / account conversion / qualifying deposit

08

- 01 **Priya:** My June statement has a fifteen-dollar maintenance charge. Your current schedule shows ten dollars. Why was I charged more?
- 02 **Daniel:** I need to check the <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. The schedule I have is effective from August first. It cannot by itself explain June's charge, and I should not assume either that the fee was correct or that it was wrong.
- 03 **Priya:** I also changed accounts earlier in the year. Could the specific product I held in June affect which fee applied?
- 04 **Daniel:** Yes. We must confirm the <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ for that cycle. The current schedule covers a particular product. I have not established that it matches the account and terms you held when the June fee was assessed.
- 05 **Priya:** The five-dollar difference does not automatically establish a refund. We need the relevant records.
- 06 **Daniel:** Correct. A <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ must follow the actual review. I will not promise a credit merely because two figures differ, and I will not defend the charge without checking its basis.
- 07 **Priya:** I expected a waiver. My account had a positive balance near the end of June.
- 08 **Daniel:** We need the actual <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. It may use a specific balance measure or another criterion. A positive balance on one day is not automatically evidence that the relevant condition was met throughout its required basis.
- 09 **Priya:** If the terms use an average daily balance, that would be different from the balance on the last day of the statement period.
- 10 **Daniel:** Exactly. <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and a closing balance are different measures. We must use the measure required by the applicable June terms rather than choose whichever figure is easiest to locate or seems most favorable.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Priya:** I also received a deposit that month. Please check whether it counted for the waiver instead of assuming every deposit qualifies.
- 12 **Daniel:** I will check the <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ definition if that condition is relevant. The review should connect the actual transaction details to the terms, not infer eligibility or ineligibility from a broad description alone.
- 13 **Priya:** Please check the account change and any fee notice. Which terms applied when?
- 14 **Daniel:** Yes. We will trace any relevant <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and change notice. That history may help establish the correct product and effective period. We should not apply today's information backward simply because it is the first document available.
- 15 **Priya:** Please keep the actual complaint tied to the June cycle. I am not asking you to decide whether August's fee is correct.
- 16 **Daniel:** I will record the <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and fifteen-dollar posting explicitly. The current ten-dollar schedule is a comparison document, not a substitute for the historical account, fee, and waiver evidence needed to answer your question.
- 17 **Priya:** When will you update me, even if older records take longer to retrieve?
- 18 **Daniel:** I will update the <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and contact you Tuesday at fifteen hundred. If something remains missing, I will identify it. That is an update appointment, not a guaranteed account-credit date.
- 19 **Priya:** That gives me a clear next step. Please explain the eventual result using the correct product, period, and waiver rules.
- 20 **Daniel:** Agreed. The <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ will need that basis, along with applicable further-review information. For now, the fee question remains open; we have not established whether the charge stands or should be corrected.

08

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. historical terms | 2. account product | 3. refund decision | 4. waiver condition | 5. Average daily balance | 6. qualifying deposit | 7. account conversion | 8. statement cycle | 9. service record | 10. case resolution

# Check the relevant fee period

## F Say it

A customer questions a \$12 fee for April. The available schedule is effective from 1 July and shows \$8. The April product and waiver conditions are unchecked. The next review update is Wednesday.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

Wednesday / 12 / 1 July / 8

08

Representative: "The disputed April charge is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Customer: "The available schedule takes effect on <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Representative: "That schedule shows <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Customer: "The next review update is <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. 12 | 2. 1 July | 3. 8 | 4. Wednesday

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# 01 Briefing and language checks

## Account Opening and KYC

### A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is missing from A62?

**A. Requested ownership information**

The brief supplies signatory details but leaves the requested ownership information incomplete.

2. What does the local process require before approval here?

**B. Completion of the required review**

The stated process makes review completion a prerequisite for this application, without guaranteeing approval afterward.

3. What does Thursday at 11:00 represent?

**B. A review-status update**

Zoya promises a status update, not account approval or verification of missing information.

### D Language checks / page 9

1. Which explanation is accurate?

**B. We have signatory details, but the requested ownership information is incomplete.**

The accurate statement distinguishes the information supplied from the separate ownership gap without inventing universal rules.

2. What can Zoya promise?

**B. A specific missing-information list and a Thursday status update**

Zoya can provide the stated communication steps, but the brief gives no authority to guarantee approval or bypass review.

3. Which statement improperly generalizes the case?

**D. Every additional account always requires identical new ownership collection.**

The case does not establish a universal repeat-collection rule, and current U.S. relief can affect additional-account requirements.

4. What does a completed information package establish by itself?

**D. Information is supplied for review, not automatic approval.**

Submission, verification, and approval are distinct stages, so completed paperwork alone does not establish acceptance.

# 01 Conversation answers

## Account Opening and KYC

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. ownership structure.** Turn 2. Ownership structure identifies ownership interests; permission to sign does not establish those interests.
- 2. authorized signatory.** Turn 4. A signatory can act under the mandate without necessarily meeting the applicable ownership definition.
- 3. customer due diligence.** Turn 6. The stated local process requires this customer review before approval; the conversation cannot bypass it.
- 4. outstanding requirement.** Turn 8. The outstanding requirement identifies a specific gap, allowing a focused request instead of unnecessary duplication.
- 5. risk-based procedure.** Turn 10. A risk-based procedure depends on relevant customer circumstances and requirements, not identical rules for every account.
- 6. verification status.** Turn 12. Verification status describes the checks; receiving documents does not establish their verification or approval.
- 7. exception review.** Turn 14. An exception needs authorized review; urgency or a frontline discussion does not approve a departure.
- 8. nature and purpose.** Turn 16. Nature and purpose describes intended account use, distinct from the customer's ownership and signing authority.
- 9. account application.** Turn 18. An account application is a request; a status update does not establish that it is approved.
- 10. approval authority.** Turn 20. Approval authority identifies the permitted decision-maker; completed paperwork does not replace that person's decision.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 12

#### 1. B14

Officer: "The application reference is B14."

B14 is the specific account-application identifier supplied in this case.

#### 2. ownership chart

Applicant: "The missing document is the ownership chart."

The brief identifies the ownership chart as missing while signatory details are already supplied.

#### 3. Hana

Officer: "The review coordinator is Hana."

Hana is explicitly responsible for coordinating the stated review.

#### 4. Monday at 10:00

Applicant: "The next status update is Monday at 10:00."

Monday at ten is an update appointment, not a guaranteed approval time.

## 02 Briefing and language checks

### AML Monitoring and Suspicious Activity

#### A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What does T82 identify?

**B. Activity differing from the recorded customer profile**

The alert identifies a difference requiring review, while its explanation remains unestablished.

2. What is wrong with the draft note?

**C. It states wrongdoing as established without the supporting finding.**

The supplied facts do not establish money laundering, so the accusatory conclusion overstates the evidence.

3. What reporting decision is supplied?

**A. None**

The case deliberately provides no reporting decision, and the analyst must not invent one.

#### D Language checks / page 18

1. Which internal note fits the case?

**A. T82 identifies transfers differing from the profile; business purpose unestablished; referred for authorized review.**

The appropriate note describes the observed difference, missing context, and review action without inventing a finding or report.

2. What should the reviewer not use as proof?

**C. The customer's accent or nationality**

Accent or nationality is not evidence that the observed transactions constitute wrongdoing.

3. Which disclosure is inappropriate through an unauthorized channel?

**D. Whether a SAR exists for the customer**

Information revealing SAR existence or nonexistence is confidential and must not be disclosed through unauthorized channels.

4. What should the record preserve?

**D. Sources, observed facts, uncertainty, and the review rationale**

A useful review record separates traceable evidence from uncertainty and documents the basis for the next step.

# 02 Conversation answers

## AML Monitoring and Suspicious Activity

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. neutral description.** Turn 2. A neutral description records the observed difference without converting an unresolved concern into a proven offense.
- 2. business purpose.** Turn 4. Business purpose is the relevant explanation for the activity; it remains unestablished rather than necessarily absent or illicit.
- 3. unusual activity.** Turn 6. Unusual activity differs from the relevant pattern and requires evaluation; it is neither automatic wrongdoing nor automatic clearance.
- 4. source attribution.** Turn 8. Source attribution distinguishes records from statements or assumptions, allowing reviewers to assess each item's basis.
- 5. reporting decision.** Turn 10. A reporting decision follows the applicable assessment process; the existence of a monitoring alert does not establish one.
- 6. confidentiality restriction.** Turn 12. The confidentiality restriction protects SAR information, including existence or nonexistence, from unauthorized disclosure.
- 7. authorized channel.** Turn 14. An authorized channel limits information to the permitted review route rather than a broadly visible service note.
- 8. review rationale.** Turn 16. The review rationale explains the evidence-based reason for further assessment without substituting a label for analysis.
- 9. case escalation.** Turn 18. Case escalation routes the concern to the proper review level; it is an action rather than an established adverse finding.
- 10. alert disposition.** Turn 20. Alert disposition records the actual review outcome; it must not be guessed while assessment remains incomplete.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 21

#### 1. U19

Analyst: "The alert reference is U19."

U19 is the specific monitoring-alert identifier supplied in the case.

#### 2. unconfirmed

Reviewer: "The business purpose remains unconfirmed."

The brief does not establish the explanation for the changed activity.

#### 3. Noor

Analyst: "The assigned reviewer is Noor."

Noor is explicitly responsible for the authorized review.

#### 4. decision

Reviewer: "This alert alone does not establish a reporting decision."

An alert does not establish a reporting decision, and none is supplied here.

## 03 Briefing and language checks

### Loan Operations and Documentation

03

#### A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which agreement version governs this package?

**D. Approved version 3**

The brief explicitly identifies approved agreement version 3 as the package's governing version.

2. What does the supporting certificate reference?

**D. Version 2**

The certificate references version 2, creating the unresolved mismatch with version 3.

3. What is the affected drawdown status under the stated process?

**B. Not authorized while C4 remains unresolved**

The local process leaves the affected drawdown unauthorized pending resolution of the specific condition.

#### D Language checks / page 27

1. Which checklist correction is supported?

**C. Mark C4 unresolved pending authorized assessment of the version mismatch.**

The evidence does not yet establish C4 satisfaction for version 3, so the specific condition requires review.

2. Which statement invents a waiver?

**D. The client wants funding today, so C4 is waived.**

A requested funding date does not supply the authority or decision needed to waive a condition.

3. What should happen to the original certificate?

**B. Preserve it with its actual reference and obtain the necessary assessment.**

The original is evidence and must remain traceable while the mismatch is assessed.

4. What does resolving a document question not automatically establish?

**B. A separate release authorization unless the applicable process provides it**

Document satisfaction and funding authorization are distinct matters under the stated process and must not be conflated.



# 03 Conversation answers

## Loan Operations and Documentation

03

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. document discrepancy.** Turn 2. The document discrepancy is the observed mismatch between the certificate and approved agreement, not a conclusion about the entire loan's validity.
- 2. condition precedent.** Turn 4. The condition precedent is the requirement relevant to the proposed action; its satisfaction must be assessed against the applicable agreement.
- 3. supporting certificate.** Turn 6. The supporting certificate is evidence with an actual reference; silently changing it would conceal the mismatch instead of resolving it.
- 4. drawdown.** Turn 8. Drawdown is the use or disbursement of facility funds; it remains unauthorized under the stated process while C4 is unresolved.
- 5. waiver.** Turn 10. A waiver requires the applicable authority and decision; a client's promise or operational preference does not establish one.
- 6. version control.** Turn 12. Version control preserves which document issue applies and prevents a prior version from being silently treated as the approved one.
- 7. exception log.** Turn 14. The exception log records the specific unresolved discrepancy and its status, not an unsupported conclusion about every loan document.
- 8. document index.** Turn 16. The document index links the condition, relevant records, and decision while preserving the original evidence and its history.
- 9. release authorization.** Turn 18. Release authorization permits the disbursement; resolving one document condition does not automatically supply every remaining approval.
- 10. funding request.** Turn 20. The funding request expresses the desired disbursement; it remains distinct from the evidence review and actual authority to release funds.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 30

#### 1. N26

Officer: "The package reference is N26."

N26 is the package identifier given for this separate documentation case.

#### 2. 5

Reviewer: "The approved agreement version is 5."

Version 5 is the approved agreement, not the older certificate reference.

#### 3. 4

Officer: "The certificate refers to version 4."

Version 4 is the actual reference on the supporting certificate.

#### 4. D2

Reviewer: "The affected condition is D2."

D2 is the condition whose satisfaction remains unresolved because of the mismatch.

# 04 Briefing and language checks

## Payment Operations and Exceptions

### A Briefing checks / page 31

1. How many exceptions are resolved?

**D. 24**

Only twenty-four reviewed items are resolved; the other six reviewed items still await authorization.

2. How many exceptions remain open?

**B. 21**

Six reviewed but unresolved items plus fifteen unreviewed items give twenty-one open exceptions.

3. What does 11:00 represent?

**D. The next queue snapshot**

Eleven hundred is the next status report, not a guarantee of resolution, authorization, or settlement.

### D Language checks / page 36

1. Which breakdown reconciles to 45?

**A. 24 resolved, six awaiting authorization, fifteen unreviewed**

The mutually exclusive groups sum to forty-five without double-counting the reviewed subset.

2. Which rate is approximately 66.7%?

**A. Review rate**

Thirty reviewed divided by forty-five total exceptions gives approximately sixty-six point seven percent.

3. Which statement improperly strengthens the evidence?

**D. All 24 underlying payments have settled because their exceptions are resolved.**

Exception resolution is not evidence of underlying payment settlement, which the snapshot does not confirm.

4. What must the next report preserve?

**B. A common timestamp, denominator, and distinct stage labels**

Comparable counts need the same snapshot basis and clear stages rather than mixed timestamps or unsupported outcome claims.

# 04 Conversation answers

## Payment Operations and Exceptions

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

**1. queue snapshot.** Turn 2. The queue snapshot fixes the population and status at 10:00, preventing a review count from becoming an all-clear claim.

**2. Pending authorization.** Turn 4. Pending authorization identifies reviewed items that still require approval and therefore remain unresolved in this queue.

**3. unreviewed item.** Turn 6. An unreviewed item is one of the fifteen not examined; open items also include the six reviewed but unresolved cases.

**4. review rate.** Turn 8. Review rate measures examined items over the full population, so thirty of forty-five is approximately 66.7%.

**5. resolution rate.** Turn 10. Resolution rate uses the twenty-four exceptions meeting the defined resolution condition, producing approximately 53.3% of the forty-five-item queue.

**6. settlement.** Turn 12. Settlement is a downstream payment state requiring its actual evidence; resolving a queue exception does not confirm it.

**7. resolved exception.** Turn 14. A resolved exception has actually met the queue's condition; expected authorization does not satisfy that condition in advance.

**8. cut-off time.** Turn 16. A cut-off time applies to a specified processing cycle or service; it is not a universal promise about every payment's settlement.

**9. payment release.** Turn 18. Payment release is the authorized sending to a next stage; it must be verified separately and not inferred from a reporting appointment.

**10. exception queue.** Turn 20. The exception queue is the defined population requiring attention; its status must preserve all three groups and their common timestamp.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 39

#### 1. nine

Analyst: "The resolved count is nine."

Nine items are explicitly resolved, not all twelve reviewed items.

#### 2. eleven

Supervisor: "The open count is eleven."

Three awaiting authorization plus eight unreviewed gives eleven open exceptions.

#### 3. 60%

Analyst: "The review rate is 60%."

Twelve reviewed divided by twenty total exceptions equals sixty percent.

#### 4. 45%

Supervisor: "The resolution rate is 45%."

Nine resolved divided by twenty total exceptions equals forty-five percent.

04

# 05 Briefing and language checks

## Fraud Operations and Customer Escalation

### A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is the original notice date?

**A. 9 September**

Nine September is when the bank received the notice; posting and internal handoff dates are different.

2. Which barriers must Amir correct in this case?

**B. Requiring merchant resolution or a police report before beginning the applicable investigation**

The supplied U.S. consumer dispute must not be blocked by those stated prerequisites to initiating error resolution.

3. What outcome has been established?

**D. No final finding or credit decision is supplied.**

The brief leaves both the final finding and credit decision unspecified.

### D Language checks / page 45

1. Which message corrects the process?

**A. We will preserve your 9 September notice and not require those prerequisites to begin the applicable investigation.**

The correct message preserves the original notice and removes the improper initiation barriers in this case.

2. What does provisional credit mean?

**B. Temporary credit distinct from a final decision**

Provisional credit is temporary during the applicable investigation and does not itself decide the final outcome.

3. Which date is the posting date?

**B. 7 September**

Seven September is explicitly when the disputed transaction posted to the account.

4. Which request should Amir avoid?

**B. Asking June to disclose a PIN or one-time code in this conversation**

Secret access credentials must be protected; approved authentication should not become a request to disclose them here.

# 05 Conversation answers

## Fraud Operations and Customer Escalation

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. process correction.** Turn 2. Process correction removes the inaccurate initiation barriers without deciding the transaction's merits or promising a refund.
- 2. notice date.** Turn 4. The notice date is September ninth, when the bank received the report; a later handoff does not restart it.
- 3. transaction descriptor.** Turn 6. The transaction descriptor is the displayed identifying text and helps locate the disputed entry without establishing whether it was authorized.
- 4. unauthorized transaction.** Turn 8. Unauthorized transaction describes the customer's reported concern subject to the applicable definition and factual investigation.
- 5. Provisional credit.** Turn 10. Provisional credit is temporary during investigation and must not be described as a final permanent refund decision.
- 6. error resolution.** Turn 12. Error resolution has requirements for investigation and communication; an open case is not permission to delay indefinitely.
- 7. written confirmation.** Turn 14. Written confirmation requirements must be explained accurately within the applicable process, not invented as a universal barrier to investigation.
- 8. Customer authentication.** Turn 16. Customer authentication uses the approved identity-checking process; it does not justify requesting secret credentials in this conversation.
- 9. handoff.** Turn 18. The handoff transfers accurate context and responsibility while preserving the original notice, reported facts, and corrected process instructions.
- 10. interim update.** Turn 20. An interim update reports progress without substituting for the final finding or altering applicable investigation and credit obligations.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 48

- 1. 240**  
Specialist: "The disputed amount is 240 dollars."  
Two hundred forty dollars is the transaction amount supplied for this dispute.
- 2. 2 May**  
Customer: "The posting date was 2 May."  
Two May is the transaction posting date, distinct from notice and handoff.
- 3. 4 May**  
Specialist: "The original notice date remains 4 May."  
Four May is when the bank received notice; the later handoff does not replace it.
- 4. 6 May**  
Customer: "The internal handoff occurred on 6 May."  
Six May is the internal transfer date, not a new original notice date.

05

# 06 Briefing and language checks

## Operational Risk and Controls

### A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is the unmatched amount?

**C. \$1,250**

Two hundred fifty thousand minus two hundred forty-eight thousand seven hundred fifty equals twelve hundred fifty.

2. What is established about the cause?

**B. It remains unconfirmed.**

The brief explicitly leaves the cause unconfirmed and identifies timing only as a possibility.

3. What does the local procedure allow?

**B. Acknowledgment of a documented open exception without calling it fully matched**

The local process distinguishes review acknowledgment from claiming that an unresolved difference has been matched.

### D Language checks / page 54

1. Which control description is accurate?

**D. Reviewed with an open \$1,250 exception; cause under investigation**

The accurate status preserves the reviewed work and the outstanding difference without inventing its cause or resolution.

2. Which action is unsupported?

**B. Post an unapproved \$1,250 adjustment solely to force agreement.**

No adjustment is authorized, and forcing agreement without a basis would conceal rather than explain the difference.

3. What is needed before calling this a timing difference?

**A. Evidence establishing the timing explanation**

Timing is only a hypothesis until relevant records establish why the difference exists.

4. Which statement distinguishes two tasks correctly?

**D. Correcting the sign-off description does not itself resolve the underlying balance.**

Record correction and substantive reconciliation resolution are separate actions requiring their own basis.

# 06 Conversation answers

## Operational Risk and Controls

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

**1. unmatched balance.** Turn 2. The unmatched balance is the established 1,250-dollar difference on the stated common basis, not an explanation of its cause.

**2. timing difference.** Turn 4. A timing difference needs supporting evidence; it remains only one possible explanation in this case.

**3. control sign-off.** Turn 6. The control sign-off must state its actual meaning, distinguishing acknowledgment with an open exception from a fully matched conclusion.

**4. audit trail.** Turn 8. The audit trail preserves the original and subsequent correction so reviewers can trace what changed and why.

**5. journal entry.** Turn 10. A journal entry records an accounting event or adjustment; no unsupported balancing entry is authorized merely to force agreement.

**6. write-off.** Turn 12. A write-off requires the applicable accounting basis and authorization; relative size alone does not establish either.

**7. resolution owner.** Turn 14. The resolution owner coordinates follow-up on the difference; naming that person does not itself establish its cause or closure.

**8. evidence reference.** Turn 16. An evidence reference connects the stated balances and conclusions to the actual records, making the reconciliation reviewable.

**9. control exception.** Turn 18. The control exception is the unresolved condition in the process; recording it honestly does not determine whether or how it will be resolved.

**10. segregation of duties.** Turn 20. Segregation of duties keeps preparation, checking, and approval appropriately distinct rather than letting urgency bypass the required roles.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 57

#### 1. 90,000

Analyst: "The ledger balance is 90,000 dollars."

Ninety thousand is the supplied general-ledger amount for this separate comparison.

#### 2. 89,600

Reviewer: "The subledger balance is 89,600 dollars."

Eighty-nine thousand six hundred is the supplied supporting balance.

#### 3. 400

Analyst: "The unmatched difference is 400 dollars."

Ninety thousand minus eighty-nine thousand six hundred equals four hundred dollars.

#### 4. unknown

Reviewer: "The cause remains unknown."

The case does not establish a timing, error, or other explanation.

# 07 Briefing and language checks

## Audit and Regulatory Exams

### A Briefing checks / page 58

1. How many requested dated records are retrieved?

**A. Two of five**

The records for 10 and 24 March are retrieved; three other requested dates remain unlocated.

2. What does policy version 2 primarily describe?

**C. The control's documented design or requirements**

A policy describes intended control arrangements and is distinct from evidence that the control actually operated.

3. What can be concluded about the three unlocated records?

**A. Their retrieval is incomplete; operation is not established by that fact alone.**

Unlocated evidence leaves a gap but does not alone prove either performance or failure.

### D Language checks / page 63

1. Which package description is accurate?

**B. Policy version 2 plus records for 10 and 24 March; three requested dates outstanding**

The description accurately identifies available material and outstanding requested records without fabricating completeness or performance.

2. What is the retrieval coverage?

**A. 40% of the five requested dated records**

Two retrieved records divided by five requested dates gives forty percent retrieval coverage only.

3. Which action would misrepresent the evidence?

**B. Create today's sign-off and present it as an original March record.**

A later record must not be presented as contemporaneous evidence that was created in March.

4. What should Yusuf report Wednesday if records remain missing?

**A. The actual retrieval status and outstanding dates**

The promise concerns an accurate status update even if the evidence-retrieval work remains incomplete.



# 07 Conversation answers

## Audit and Regulatory Exams

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

**1. control design.** Turn 2. Control design states how the control should work; the policy alone does not establish operation on the requested dates.

**2. evidence inventory.** Turn 4. The evidence inventory lists available and outstanding records, preserving the two retrieved dates and three remaining gaps.

**3. Operating effectiveness.** Turn 6. Operating effectiveness concerns actual control performance; the percentage of retrieved records is not a score of that performance.

**4. evidence gap.** Turn 8. An evidence gap means support is missing; it does not by itself prove either that the control operated or that it failed.

**5. evidence mapping.** Turn 10. Evidence mapping links each requested item to its supporting record or explicit outstanding status, preventing a misleading package-level claim.

**6. record custodian.** Turn 12. The record custodian is responsible for relevant records and can assist retrieval without inventing evidence or guaranteeing its existence.

**7. contemporaneous record.** Turn 14. A contemporaneous record was created at or near the event; a new sign-off cannot be represented as original March evidence.

**8. retrospective explanation.** Turn 16. A retrospective explanation is a later account that must be labeled as such, not substituted deceptively for historical evidence.

**9. retrieval status.** Turn 18. Retrieval status reports what has actually been located; the update appointment does not guarantee that every missing record will be found.

**10. examiner conclusion.** Turn 20. The examiner conclusion follows the actual supervisory assessment; the team must not invent approval from its own document submission.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 66

#### 1. four

Coordinator: "The number of requested dated records is four."

Four is the requested population for this separate evidence-retrieval task.

#### 2. three

Owner: "The number retrieved is three."

Three records are actually available; the fourth remains unlocated.

#### 3. 75%

Coordinator: "Retrieval coverage is 75%."

Three retrieved divided by four requested equals seventy-five percent, not a control-effectiveness score.

#### 4. Friday

Owner: "The next retrieval update is due Friday."

Friday is the status-update commitment, not a guarantee of complete evidence or examiner approval.

# 08 Briefing and language checks

## Customer Complaints and Fair Treatment

### A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What charge is disputed?

**C. A \$15 maintenance charge for the June cycle**

Priya asks about fifteen dollars charged for the June statement cycle.

2. What is the effective date of Daniel's available schedule?

**A. 1 August**

The schedule is explicitly effective from 1 August and is not automatically applicable to June.

3. What remains unchecked?

**A. June product, applicable historical terms, and waiver eligibility**

The brief identifies these three unreviewed facts as necessary to assess the actual charge.

### D Language checks / page 72

1. Which first reply is accurate?

**D. I will check the June product, historical terms, and waiver conditions before deciding the charge.**

The accurate reply identifies the relevant period and facts without using current terms to invent a historical conclusion.

2. Why does the 1 August date matter?

**D. It limits the current schedule's applicability and does not automatically establish June terms.**

Effective dates help identify which terms apply; the current document alone does not establish the earlier cycle's rules.

3. Which waiver assumption is unsupported?

**C. Any deposit automatically satisfies every qualifying-deposit condition.**

Qualifying deposits are defined by the actual terms, so not every deposit necessarily satisfies the condition.

4. What should Tuesday's update do if the review remains incomplete?

**A. Identify the actual outstanding records and review status.**

The commitment is to communicate the real status, not manufacture an outcome before the evidence is complete.

# 08 Conversation answers

## Customer Complaints and Fair Treatment

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

**1. historical terms.** Turn 2. Historical terms establish what applied in June; the current schedule does not automatically govern that earlier cycle.

**2. account product.** Turn 4. Account product identifies the specific account arrangement held during the relevant period, which can affect applicable charges and conditions.

**3. refund decision.** Turn 6. A refund decision needs the applicable facts and terms; a numerical difference between schedules does not establish an error or entitlement.

**4. waiver condition.** Turn 8. A waiver condition defines eligibility under the terms; a positive balance at one point does not establish every possible balance requirement.

**5. Average daily balance.** Turn 10. Average daily balance averages the defined daily balances over a period; it is not interchangeable with a single closing balance.

**6. qualifying deposit.** Turn 12. A qualifying deposit meets the actual terms; receiving some deposit does not necessarily satisfy a specified waiver criterion.

**7. account conversion.** Turn 14. Account conversion changes the account arrangement and may affect which terms apply; its timing needs evidence rather than assumption.

**8. statement cycle.** Turn 16. The statement cycle identifies the period disputed; the June complaint must not be replaced with an unrelated August fee question.

**9. service record.** Turn 18. The service record preserves the complaint and follow-up; an update appointment does not establish a refund or completed review.

**10. case resolution.** Turn 20. Case resolution must reflect a supported outcome addressing the actual historical fee question, not merely the sending of an acknowledgment.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 75

#### 1. 12

Representative: "The disputed April charge is 12 dollars."

Twelve dollars is the actual fee in the disputed April cycle.

#### 2. 1 July

Customer: "The available schedule takes effect on 1 July."

One July is the stated effective date, not proof of the earlier April terms.

#### 3. 8

Representative: "That schedule shows 8 dollars."

Eight dollars is the amount on the later schedule, not an established April entitlement.

#### 4. Wednesday

Customer: "The next review update is Wednesday."

Wednesday is the communication appointment, not a guaranteed fee correction.

08

# Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

## 01 Account Opening and KYC

**Identify the application:** We are reviewing business-account application A62.

**Separate roles:** Signing authority and beneficial ownership are different questions.

**Make the request specific:** I will provide the outstanding-information list.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

## 02 AML Monitoring and Suspicious Activity

**Identify the item:** We are reviewing monitoring alert T82.

**Remove the unsupported finding:** Do not describe money laundering as proven.

**Attribute the source:** Separate system records from unverified explanations.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

## 03 Loan Operations and Documentation

**Name the package:** We are reviewing loan package L73.

**Locate the affected condition:** The mismatch concerns condition C4.

**Request authorized review:** Please assess whether the certificate satisfies C4 for version 3.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

## 04 Payment Operations and Exceptions

**Timestamp the report:** This is the queue snapshot at 10:00 local time.

**Separate the resolved group:** Twenty-four are resolved under the queue process.

**Explain the arithmetic:** Six awaiting authorization plus fifteen unreviewed equals twenty-one.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

# Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

## 05 Fraud Operations and Customer Escalation

**Acknowledge the conflict:** You received two different process explanations.

**Separate the posting date:** The transaction posted on 7 September.

**Avoid repeated intake:** I will check what the file already contains.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

## 06 Operational Risk and Controls

**State the comparison:** The ledger shows \$250,000 and the subledger \$248,750.

**Preserve the unknown:** The cause has not been confirmed.

**Separate correction and resolution:** Fixing the label does not resolve the balance difference.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

## 07 Audit and Regulatory Exams

**Restate the request:** The examiner requested R9 evidence for five specified March dates.

**State retrieved records:** We have the records for 10 and 24 March.

**Preserve uncertainty:** Missing retrieved evidence does not by itself prove performance or failure.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

## 08 Customer Complaints and Fair Treatment

**Restate the charge:** You are asking about the \$15 maintenance charge for June.

**Check the product:** I need to confirm the account product held during that cycle.

**Avoid a premature refund:** The \$5 difference does not by itself establish a refund.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                       |                                    |    |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----|
| <b>account application</b>            | review the account application     | 6  |
| <b>account conversion</b>             | review an account conversion       | 69 |
| <b>account credit</b>                 | verify an account credit           | 69 |
| <b>account mandate</b>                | review the account mandate         | 5  |
| <b>account product</b>                | verify the account product         | 68 |
| <b>adjustment</b>                     | authorize an adjustment            | 50 |
| <b>alert disposition</b>              | document the alert disposition     | 14 |
| <b>amendment</b>                      | review an amendment                | 23 |
| <b>Anti-Money Laundering (AML)</b>    | conduct an AML review              | 14 |
| <b>approval authority</b>             | confirm approval authority         | 6  |
| <b>approved version</b>               | identify the approved version      | 23 |
| <b>audit trail</b>                    | preserve the audit trail           | 51 |
| <b>authorized channel</b>             | use an authorized channel          | 15 |
| <b>authorized signatory</b>           | verify the authorized signatory    | 5  |
| <b>Automated Clearing House (ACH)</b> | process an ACH payment             | 32 |
| <b>average daily balance</b>          | calculate average daily balance    | 68 |
| <b>Bank Secrecy Act (BSA)</b>         | assess applicable BSA requirements | 14 |
| <b>beneficial owner</b>               | identify the beneficial owner      | 5  |
| <b>beneficiary</b>                    | verify beneficiary details         | 33 |
| <b>billing period</b>                 | confirm the billing period         | 68 |
| <b>business purpose</b>               | clarify the business purpose       | 14 |
| <b>case escalation</b>                | coordinate case escalation         | 14 |
| <b>case reference</b>                 | provide the case reference         | 42 |
| <b>case resolution</b>                | document case resolution           | 69 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                                                                         |    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>change notice</b> retrieve the change notice                                         | 69 |
| <b>collateral</b> identify the collateral                                               | 24 |
| <b>complaint reference</b> provide a complaint reference                                | 69 |
| <b>condition precedent</b> verify a condition precedent                                 | 23 |
| <b>conditions checklist</b> update the conditions checklist                             | 24 |
| <b>confidentiality restriction</b> observe confidentiality restrictions                 | 15 |
| <b>consent</b> obtain the required consent                                              | 23 |
| <b>contemporaneous record</b> preserve a contemporaneous record                         | 60 |
| <b>contextual information</b> obtain contextual information                             | 15 |
| <b>control deficiency</b> assess a control deficiency                                   | 51 |
| <b>control design</b> explain control design                                            | 59 |
| <b>control exception</b> document a control exception                                   | 51 |
| <b>control person</b> identify the control person                                       | 5  |
| <b>control sign-off</b> qualify the control sign-off                                    | 50 |
| <b>corroborating evidence</b> review corroborating evidence                             | 15 |
| <b>covenant</b> monitor a covenant                                                      | 24 |
| <b>customer authentication</b> complete customer authentication                         | 42 |
| <b>customer due diligence (CDD)</b> conduct customer due diligence                      | 5  |
| <b>Customer Identification Program (CIP)</b> follow the Customer Identification Program | 5  |
| <b>customer profile</b> compare the customer profile                                    | 14 |
| <b>customer risk profile</b> maintain the customer risk profile                         | 6  |
| <b>cut-off time</b> verify the cut-off time                                             | 33 |
| <b>dated evidence</b> provide dated evidence                                            | 59 |
| <b>debit-card dispute</b> handle a debit-card dispute                                   | 41 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                       |                                        |    |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----|
| <b>disputed transaction</b>           | record the disputed transaction        | 41 |
| <b>document discrepancy</b>           | record a document discrepancy          | 23 |
| <b>document index</b>                 | maintain the document index            | 24 |
| <b>document retention</b>             | follow document-retention requirements | 24 |
| <b>documentary verification</b>       | perform documentary verification       | 5  |
| <b>drawdown</b>                       | authorize a drawdown                   | 23 |
| <b>duplicate payment</b>              | review a possible duplicate payment    | 33 |
| <b>effective date</b>                 | confirm the effective date             | 68 |
| <b>electronic fund transfer (EFT)</b> | identify the electronic fund transfer  | 41 |
| <b>eligibility</b>                    | verify waiver eligibility              | 69 |
| <b>error resolution</b>               | follow error-resolution requirements   | 42 |
| <b>evidence gap</b>                   | disclose an evidence gap               | 60 |
| <b>evidence inventory</b>             | maintain an evidence inventory         | 59 |
| <b>evidence mapping</b>               | complete evidence mapping              | 60 |
| <b>evidence reference</b>             | add an evidence reference              | 51 |
| <b>examination request</b>            | respond to an examination request      | 59 |
| <b>examiner conclusion</b>            | distinguish the examiner conclusion    | 60 |
| <b>exception aging</b>                | monitor exception aging                | 51 |
| <b>exception log</b>                  | update the exception log               | 24 |
| <b>exception queue</b>                | monitor the exception queue            | 32 |
| <b>exception review</b>               | request an exception review            | 6  |
| <b>executed document</b>              | retain the executed document           | 23 |
| <b>execution copy</b>                 | confirm the execution copy             | 23 |
| <b>execution record</b>               | retrieve the execution record          | 59 |



# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                  |                                     |    |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----|
| <b>expected activity</b>         | describe expected activity          | 6  |
| <b>facility agent</b>            | contact the facility agent          | 24 |
| <b>fee assessment</b>            | examine the fee assessment          | 69 |
| <b>fee schedule</b>              | check the fee schedule              | 68 |
| <b>final credit</b>              | distinguish final credit            | 41 |
| <b>final finding</b>             | explain the final finding           | 42 |
| <b>funding request</b>           | review the funding request          | 24 |
| <b>further review</b>            | explain further-review options      | 69 |
| <b>general ledger (GL)</b>       | reconcile the general ledger        | 50 |
| <b>guarantor</b>                 | confirm the guarantor               | 24 |
| <b>handoff</b>                   | document the handoff                | 42 |
| <b>historical schedule</b>       | obtain the historical schedule      | 69 |
| <b>historical terms</b>          | retrieve historical terms           | 68 |
| <b>identity verification</b>     | complete identity verification      | 5  |
| <b>interim update</b>            | provide an interim update           | 42 |
| <b>investigation</b>             | begin the applicable investigation  | 41 |
| <b>journal entry</b>             | review a journal entry              | 50 |
| <b>Know Your Customer (KYC)</b>  | complete KYC checks                 | 5  |
| <b>legal entity</b>              | identify the legal entity           | 5  |
| <b>loan agreement</b>            | review the loan agreement           | 23 |
| <b>loan facility</b>             | administer a loan facility          | 23 |
| <b>maintenance fee</b>           | review a maintenance fee            | 68 |
| <b>maker-checker control</b>     | apply a maker-checker control       | 51 |
| <b>management representation</b> | qualify a management representation | 60 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                                                         |    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>merchant</b> identify the merchant                                   | 41 |
| <b>minimum balance</b> check the minimum-balance condition              | 68 |
| <b>monitoring alert</b> investigate a monitoring alert                  | 14 |
| <b>nature and purpose</b> establish the nature and purpose              | 6  |
| <b>need-to-know basis</b> share on a need-to-know basis                 | 15 |
| <b>neutral description</b> use a neutral description                    | 15 |
| <b>non-documentary verification</b> assess non-documentary verification | 5  |
| <b>notice date</b> retain the original notice date                      | 41 |
| <b>notice of error</b> preserve the notice of error                     | 41 |
| <b>notification requirement</b> verify notification requirements        | 42 |
| <b>observed activity</b> describe observed activity                     | 14 |
| <b>onboarding</b> coordinate customer onboarding                        | 6  |
| <b>operating effectiveness</b> assess operating effectiveness           | 59 |
| <b>operational loss</b> record an operational loss                      | 51 |
| <b>originator</b> identify the originator                               | 33 |
| <b>outstanding requirement</b> identify an outstanding requirement      | 6  |
| <b>ownership structure</b> document the ownership structure             | 5  |
| <b>payment exception</b> investigate a payment exception                | 32 |
| <b>payment instruction</b> validate a payment instruction               | 32 |
| <b>payment rail</b> identify the payment rail                           | 32 |
| <b>payment release</b> confirm payment release                          | 33 |
| <b>pending authorization</b> identify pending authorization             | 32 |
| <b>period coverage</b> assess period coverage                           | 60 |
| <b>population</b> define the review population                          | 59 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                          |                                         |    |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----|
| <b>posting date</b>                      | distinguish the posting date            | 41 |
| <b>posting entry</b>                     | trace the posting entry                 | 68 |
| <b>preparer</b>                          | identify the preparer                   | 50 |
| <b>process correction</b>                | record the process correction           | 42 |
| <b>provisional credit</b>                | explain provisional credit              | 41 |
| <b>qualifying deposit</b>                | identify a qualifying deposit           | 68 |
| <b>queue snapshot</b>                    | timestamp the queue snapshot            | 32 |
| <b>real-time gross settlement (RTGS)</b> | distinguish RTGS processing             | 32 |
| <b>reconciliation</b>                    | perform a reconciliation                | 50 |
| <b>reconciling item</b>                  | investigate a reconciling item          | 50 |
| <b>record custodian</b>                  | contact the record custodian            | 60 |
| <b>refund decision</b>                   | explain the refund decision             | 69 |
| <b>Regulation E</b>                      | apply the relevant Regulation E process | 41 |
| <b>regulatory examination</b>            | coordinate a regulatory examination     | 59 |
| <b>release authorization</b>             | verify release authorization            | 24 |
| <b>repair</b>                            | route a payment repair                  | 33 |
| <b>reperformance</b>                     | arrange reperformance                   | 51 |
| <b>reporting decision</b>                | distinguish the reporting decision      | 15 |
| <b>request reference</b>                 | retain the request reference            | 59 |
| <b>resolution owner</b>                  | assign a resolution owner               | 51 |
| <b>resolution rate</b>                   | calculate the resolution rate           | 33 |
| <b>resolved exception</b>                | record a resolved exception             | 32 |
| <b>response package</b>                  | assemble the response package           | 60 |
| <b>retrieval status</b>                  | report retrieval status                 | 60 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                  |                                   |    |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----|
| <b>retroactive application</b>   | question retroactive application  | 69 |
| <b>retrospective explanation</b> | label a retrospective explanation | 60 |
| <b>return</b>                    | investigate a payment return      | 33 |
| <b>review period</b>             | identify the review period        | 59 |
| <b>review rate</b>               | calculate the review rate         | 33 |
| <b>review rationale</b>          | explain the review rationale      | 15 |
| <b>reviewed item</b>             | count reviewed items              | 32 |
| <b>reviewer</b>                  | identify the reviewer             | 51 |
| <b>reviewer sign-off</b>         | verify the reviewer sign-off      | 59 |
| <b>risk indicator</b>            | evaluate a risk indicator         | 15 |
| <b>risk-based procedure</b>      | apply a risk-based procedure      | 6  |
| <b>root-cause analysis</b>       | conduct root-cause analysis       | 51 |
| <b>routing information</b>       | validate routing information      | 33 |
| <b>sample selection</b>          | confirm the sample selection      | 59 |
| <b>security document</b>         | verify the security document      | 24 |
| <b>segregation of duties</b>     | maintain segregation of duties    | 51 |
| <b>sensitive credential</b>      | protect sensitive credentials     | 42 |
| <b>service record</b>            | update the service record         | 69 |
| <b>settlement</b>                | verify settlement status          | 33 |
| <b>source attribution</b>        | retain source attribution         | 15 |
| <b>source of funds</b>           | clarify the source of funds       | 6  |
| <b>source of wealth</b>          | distinguish source of wealth      | 6  |
| <b>statement cycle</b>           | identify the statement cycle      | 68 |
| <b>subledger</b>                 | compare the subledger             | 50 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                         |                                           |    |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>supporting certificate</b>           | examine a supporting certificate          | 23 |
| <b>supporting information</b>           | request supporting information            | 42 |
| <b>supporting records</b>               | preserve supporting records               | 15 |
| <b>supporting schedule</b>              | retain the supporting schedule            | 50 |
| <b>suspicious activity</b>              | evaluate suspicious activity              | 14 |
| <b>Suspicious Activity Report (SAR)</b> | protect SAR confidentiality               | 14 |
| <b>test of control</b>                  | perform a test of control                 | 60 |
| <b>timing difference</b>                | substantiate a timing difference          | 50 |
| <b>transaction descriptor</b>           | check the transaction descriptor          | 42 |
| <b>transaction monitoring</b>           | perform transaction monitoring            | 14 |
| <b>transaction narrative</b>            | prepare a transaction narrative           | 15 |
| <b>unauthorized transaction</b>         | report an unauthorized transaction        | 41 |
| <b>unmatched balance</b>                | report an unmatched balance               | 50 |
| <b>unreviewed item</b>                  | prioritize unreviewed items               | 32 |
| <b>unusual activity</b>                 | assess unusual activity                   | 14 |
| <b>value date</b>                       | confirm the value date                    | 33 |
| <b>verification status</b>              | report verification status                | 6  |
| <b>version control</b>                  | maintain version control                  | 24 |
| <b>waiver</b>                           | confirm a waiver                          | 23 |
| <b>waiver condition</b>                 | assess a waiver condition                 | 68 |
| <b>walkthrough</b>                      | conduct a process walkthrough             | 60 |
| <b>wire transfer</b>                    | track a wire transfer                     | 32 |
| <b>write-off</b>                        | approve a write-off                       | 50 |
| <b>written confirmation</b>             | explain written-confirmation requirements | 42 |

# Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

## **[1] Financial Crimes Enforcement Network. Customer Due Diligence Rule FAQs.**

[Open the original source](#)

Background on customer checks, ownership information, and 2026 account-opening relief. The fictional application uses stated local requirements, not a universal collection rule. Checked 1 October 2026.

## **[2] Federal Financial Institutions Examination Council. Suspicious Activity Reporting: Overview.**

[Open the original source](#)

Background on alerts, review, reporting, and confidentiality. The manual flags newer interagency guidance; this book prescribes no filing threshold or investigation procedure. Checked 1 October 2026.

## **[3] Consumer Financial Protection Bureau. Electronic Fund Transfers FAQs.**

[Open the original source](#)

Background on U.S. consumer electronic-transfer disputes. The fictional conversation distinguishes intake, investigation, provisional credit, and final decisions without inventing universal deadlines. Checked 1 October 2026.

## **[4] Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Comptroller's Handbook: Internal Control.**

[Open the original source](#)

Background on control design, performance, records, and review. The original reconciliation and examination cases are language exercises, not audit conclusions. Checked 1 October 2026.

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## **Phil Stilwell**

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